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Chikkaballapura**

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Foreword

The National Conference on Language, Literature, and Culture stands as a testament to the significance of interdisciplinary studies in shaping our understanding of human expression and society. With a focus on language's transformative power, literature's artistic charm, and culture's profound impact, this conference brings together scholars, researchers, educators, and enthusiasts to delve into the intricacies of communication and its multifaceted connections to the world around us.

This book comprises contributions from esteemed researchers and scholars who have shared their valuable insights and groundbreaking research during the conference. Their collective knowledge has added depth and breadth to the exploration of language, literature, and culture.

As we present this compilation to the academic community, we hope it will serve as a reservoir of inspiration and knowledge, fostering further research, dialogue, and appreciation for the diverse aspects of language, literature, and culture. May it encourage us all to continue our quest for understanding and embracing the ever-evolving tapestry of human expression.

Prof. Manohar Narajji
Director, NES

Preface

It is with great delight and profound enthusiasm that we present the proceeding of the One-day National Conference titled “BHASHA SAMPADA” on “Literature, Language, Culture and Ideology” organized by the Department of Kannada, English, Sanskrit, Hindi and IQAC, Nagarjuna college of Management Studies in association with Bengaluru North University, Tamaka, Kolar and Dravidian University, Kuppam, Andhra Pradesh on 18th August, 2023. The compilation is the culmination of a remarkable intellectual journey, bringing together academicians, scholars, researchers, and students from diverse academic disciplines under one roof to explore the recent issues, concerns and development in the realm of literature, language, culture and ideology. This conference sought to gain insights into the interwoven dynamics of literature, language, and culture fostering a deeper understanding with impact they have on society and individual lives. The readers find an array of research papers, essays, and reflection that embody the essence of the presentation. Each commitment divers into the key viewpoints of writing, dialect and culture from creative viewpoints.

We are impressed by the dedication and intellectual rigor demonstrated by each contributor. Their passion for the subject is exemplary, and their work serves as a testament to the ever-expanding horizon of knowledge in the field of literature, language, and culture. We would like to extend our heartfelt gratitude to all the scholars, presenters, resource

persons and participants who made this conference a great success. Together, let us embark on a journey of intellectual discovery, where the power of language, the beauty of culture, and the magic of literature converge to inspire and enlighten us all.

We hope that the conference proceeding will serve as a source of inspiration for researchers, scholars and students to initiate meaningful discussions, foster cross-cultural understanding, and pave the way for new avenues of research with the domains of literature, language and culture.

Wishing you a fruitful and enriching experience at the One Day National Conference on 'Bhasha Sampada', explore the beauty of language, culture, literature and ideology through English, Hindi and Sanskrit.

Chief Editor
Dr. Anandamma N

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1. A PLOT OF FEMINISTS TO HER POSITION THROUGH THE FILM “MEHENDI”

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Pooja is a young lawyer, a newlywed bride to Niranjana Chardhri, Pooja comes from a middle-class family. She loves her husband with all her heart and is happy to be wed into a home where her in-laws are like her parents and her sister-in-law friend of her. In the beginning, everything seems to appear to be fine, but it is soon revealed that Niranjana Chardhri and his family are money-hungry extortionists, who only want ‘BAHU’ so that they could financially exploit their Bahu Pooja. When her father refuses to pay ten lakh to Niranjana Chardhri. So her in-laws are furious and start to torture Pooja. But Pooja undergoes all the torture given by her in-laws silently; even Pooja realizes that she is intentionally being hassled and hazed by her in-laws for money.

Pooja also comes to know that her husband is a brother-monger and has no real interest in her, knowing all this she will be quiet and faces all the torture.

Here we see the male domination, first of all he does not have any responsibility towards his house and even towards his newly wedded wife, leaving his wife alone in house and going to a brothel's house. But he expects that his wife to be good and sincere towards him.

In the course of time, when Niranjan goes to brothel's place, he gets framed in the murder of a brothel- worker and was sentenced to hang him. The whole family was in tensed and tries everything to secure his release. That night a mysterious man, a photographer Mr. Rajeshwar visits their house, and says that he can save Niranjan ,the photos he has can prove him innocent, hearing this his parents becomes very happy. But the photographer (Rajeshwar) says he will give them the photo's only if Pooja agrees to spend a night with him in his house.

Unfortunately, it is Pooja who has to pay the price of being a lawyer and his wife. Unwilling Pooja goes to his house that night, To save her husband's life, and all this is observed by her in-laws .Once Pooja goes to his house, but the man does nothing to Pooj a, because he wanted spoil her reputations in the society and with her in-laws. After Niranjana has released from jail, his mother turns him against Pooja and expels her from the house calling her characterless for spending the night with an unknown man's house.

We presume a hint of Ramayana, when Sita was taken away by Ravana, Lord Rama doubts Sita's chastity, and Sita was asked to undergo a trial by fire (Agni Pariksha) from the early time we see only women should prove their chastity. Pooja, was also been doubted by her husband Niranjan of her chastity even though Mr. Rajeshwar had not even touched her, like Ravana towards Maa Sita.

Niranjan as a man again dominates over his wife Pooja, asking his mother to beat Pooja and throw her out of the house. It is only after being thrown out Pooja's unborn child of Niranjan is killed in the womb.

Pooja being an expert lawyer, finally decides to file divorce with her husband Niranjan Chaudhari, for not looking Pooja like a human and always tortured by his parents and

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himself. Pooja's father and her sister go and beg her in-laws to take her back into the house. They were insulted by them. All this made Pooja to make up her mind to teach her husband and her in-laws a lesson. Being educated and a lawyer, she filed a case against her sister-in-law's husband who had murdered her father.

Here is another character called 'BILLU' the seemingly homosexual, cross-dress local entertainer who would perform in wedding and like a feminine be lewd, lascivious and even criminal. In the end, Billu rapes Niranjana's sister. He does this to take revenge on Chaudhri, one who always humiliated and also puts in the jail in the robbery case, which was taken by Chaudhri's wife itself.

Here we again see man's domination on Niranjana's sister where Billu, who would not fight with Chaudhri, had taken revenge on the young innocent girl. It was again who has to pay for her father.

Men are the dominators over women. Society and men think that a woman's worth is always tied to her husband. A wife is always expected to be a jerk. She is always expected to be forgiving and always compassing with time.

In this movie not only Pooja, Billu faced discrimination. Pooja's and Niranjana's sisters too have undergone this humiliation, because men thought women were like the puppets in the hands of men.

Pooja after all these happenings, thinks about why didn't she not think twice before saving her husband's life, since she is a good wife and being an educated lady and to keep a family together, never thought she has to face all torture. So she saves him.

Throughout we haven't seen how Pooja was struggling and ultimately she gets a victory over her villainous in-laws. After Niranjana is accidentally killed at hands of his own

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mother, the evil in-laws finally calmed to their senses and realize their mistake, they fall on Pooja's feet for forgiveness and finally end up accepting Pooja as their daughter in-law.

Conclusion

The story deals with a woman's struggle and ultimate victory over her villainous in-law.

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2. GENDER STUDIES

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Abstract:

Gender studies is an interdisciplinary academic field devoted to analyzing gender identity and gendered representation. Gender studies originated in the field of women's studies, concerning women, feminism, gender, and politics. The field now overlaps with queer studies and men's studies.

Introduction:

We are surrounded by gender lore from the time we are very small. It is ever-present in conversation, humour, and conflict, and it is called upon to explain everything from driving styles to food preferences. Gender is Embedded so thoroughly in our institutions, our actions, our beliefs, and our desires, that it appears to us to be completely natural. The world swarms with Ideas about gender – and these ideas are so common place that we take it for granted that they are true, accepting common adage as scientific fact. As scholars and researchers, though, it is our job to look beyond what appears to be common sense to find not simply what truth might be behind it, but how it came to be common sense.

History:

In 1955, the controversial and innovative sexologist John

Money first used the term “gender” in a way that we all now take for granted: to describe a human characteristic. Money’s work broke new ground, opening a new field of research in sexual science and giving currency to medical ideas about human sexuality.

Purpose:

Gender studies provides an insight into the history, philosophy and the regulation of humans. Through this, learners understand what makes us male, female, transgender and intersex.

What is Gender Studies?

Gender Studies is an interdisciplinary field that focuses on the complex interaction of gender with other identity markers such as race, ethnicity, sexuality, nation, and religion.

Description:

GENDER STUDIES is an individual’s self-conception as a man or woman or as a boy or girl or as some combination of man/boy and woman/girl or as someone fluctuating between man/boy and woman/girl or as someone outside those categories altogether. It is distinguished from actual biological sex. Gender identity is our internal experience and naming of our gender. There are many different gender identities, including male, female, transgender, gender neutral. GENDER STUDIES School of Distance Education, University of Calicut 17 binary, a gender, pan-gender, gender-queer, two-spirit, third gender, and all, none or a combination of these. All societies have a set of gender categories that can serve as the basis of a person’s self – identity in relation to other members of society.

Gender identity is not the same as one's gender role, which concerns the set of behavior and attitudes generally considered appropriate for a particular sex. The term gender identity was originally coined by Robert. J. Stoller in 1964. The term gender identity and core Identity were first used with their current meaning-One's personal experience of one's own gender-sometimes in the 1960s. To this day they are usually used in that sense though a few scholars additionally use the term to refer to the sexual orientation and sexual identity categories gay, lesbian and bisexual.

It is precisely because gender seems natural, and beliefs about gender seem to be obvious truths, that we need to step back and examine gender from a new perspective. Doing this requires that we suspend what we are used to and what feels comfortable, and question some of our most fundamental beliefs. This is not easy, for gender is so central to our understanding of ourselves and of the world that it is difficult to pull back and examine it from new perspectives. But it is precisely the fact that gender seems self-evident that makes the study of gender interesting.

It brings the challenge to uncover the process of construction that creates what we have so long thought of as natural and inexorable – to study gender not as given, but as an accomplishment; not simply as cause, but as effect; and not just as individual, but as social. The results of failure to recognize this challenge are manifest not only in the popular media, but in academic work on language and gender as well. As a result, some gender scholarship does as much to rectify and support existing beliefs as to promote more reflective and informed thinking about Gender.

Conclusion:

In retrospect, then, it is necessary to understand gender studies not only as a discipline premised upon

this fundamental axiom—that gender represents, and performativity constitutes, relations of power—but as a field whose own interests have been structured by other questions. Based on the analysis, it is found that in certain categories male and female representations is in balance, but in other categories male and female representation still contain gender bias. Gender bias is still found in visibility in which males are portrayed as leader and initiator. A study reveals that women appear largely in material roles, while decision makers and protectors tend to be male. In other words male characters tend to “choose” and “decide” while female characters do not.

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3. BACK TO THE ROOTS WITH DIGITAL MEDIA

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Abstract:

This experimentation aims at elucidating some psychological methods for connecting to our roots (culture) with the help of digital media. Digital media has brought continents closer. This media acts as boon for certain accomplishments, while it is a curse in several aspects. The populous is gradually losing sanity, due to their superfluous enthusiasm about the social media platforms. We come across several applications which enable people to communicate with one another. Their communication is enhanced with impressive graphics, which are said to be the replication of human emotions. As a result, the emotional bond is enervating. The mankind is heading towards the negation of emotions from the very existence. Culture and language are unbiased part of the sentiments of the humankind. The depletion of emotions results in the decline of our rich culture. This study highlights such fatalistic effects of digital media over culture and language. Further this analysis, expounds about the ways through which we can revive the zeal for grandeur culture with the help of digital media. Thus, this research explores the effectiveness of social media in the upliftment of our grand culture and delightful language.

Back to the Roots with Digital Media:

Digital media brings continents closer. It is an unbiased part of modernization. This has a significant role in influencing

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human life. Digital media did not exist until late 20th century. Its origin is marked with the rise of digital computers. These computers use binary code to store and process data. The usage of 0's and 1's to configure and perform various tasks is known as binary code. The modern world implements such computers to ease their tedious work. Thus, PC's and media have achieved a wide acceptance in every corner of the world. Accomplishment of overseas tasks can be managed at the fingertips. The populous is intrigued by the actuality of such machines using binary code, which connects people internationally. Digital media being highly proficient in the technological regard, has both fatalistic and optimistic impact over mankind.

On the contrary, culture encompasses social behavior, institutions, knowledge, beliefs, arts, laws, customs etc. It is often attributed to a specific region. Culture is the integral part of the individual. Psychologists explore the relationship between emotions and culture. They claim culture may bear its influence in the way people express their emotions. Indian culture is rich and has a prominent scientific framework. Our culture embodies enormous knowledge about rituals and practices which are highly scientific. The circumstance during the consequential Bhopal Gas Tragedy is a predominant evidence for profound scientific rituals. The catastrophe at the Union Carbide India Ltd. Pesticide plant in Bhopal in 1984 screamed the horror loudly. About 5,00,000 people were exposed to the deadly gas methyl isocyanate (CH_3NCO). Further analysis varies on the death toll, with official account of 2,259 immediate deaths. Other people were injured and several people suffered from gas related diseases. During this hazardous condition, the families of Shri Sohan Lal S Khushwaha and Shri M L Rathore were reported to remain unscathed. This fact is validated on the

grounds of the article published in ‘The Hindu’ in April 1985. The article discloses the actuality of the survivors of Bhopal Gas Tragedy. It states that the Khushwaha family over served the effect of something and decided to rush out. Later, they decided to conduct Agnihotra, soon they got rid of the symptoms. This article cites the claims of a Russian professor, who says Agnihotra has the capability of rescuing from such catastrophes. This is possible because putting cow ghee into fire immediately reduces the atomic radiation. Thus, we understand from the above-mentioned incident that, rituals and practices that we have inherited by our predecessors has the ability to ensure protection of the individual against such menacing situations. Therefore, our culture defines a noble and secured lifestyle. However, this rich culture is hindered due to the superfluous elevation of digital media. In this research, we derive some prime methods through which we can aggrandize our culture with the help of digital media.

According to the above-stated facts, culture has a deep connection with emotions. Based on this interrelation we can study the harsh impacts of digital media. Digital world has designed many such platforms that help people communicate virtually. Programmers claim their invention to be the representation of human expressions. In modern day applications, emoji’s, GIF’s, and stickers are considered to be the replication of one’s own emotions. These tools are equivalent to languages, according to contemporary people. As a result, people are approaching the enervation of their sentiments. Most of the population busy with their errands, reply mails and texts with such tools. People are bound to experience a decrease in compassion towards fellow human-beings, if they disregard their emotions. Subsequently, mankind detaches from their culture to which they are

psychologically connected. This being a vital illustration, there are many other factors such as demoting culture on many virtual platforms, influencing the thinking process of the multitude, etc. Several additional factors impose fatal effect of digital media over our 'enchanted' culture. It spells the doom and thus decline steeply.

Digital media Inversely Proportional to Culture as well as Psychology.

Digital media in present-day has unpleasant impact over culture. In accord to reverse this effect we must derive certain prime techniques. Nowadays, many culture enthusiasts conduct many awareness programs to promote culture. The effectiveness of such programs is minimal. We cannot rely on such programs till the distant future, since, they motivate people momentarily. Therefore, the society needs eminent ways to enhance people's notion about culture. Some minute changes must be made in everyday life of people to receive far fetching results. According to this, we can equip some applications that track the routine of an individual and suggest changes that can be induced to improve their lifestyle.

Embrace Culture Don't Just Praise It Firstly, minute changes are essential for massive shifts. How does this process work? To understand this process, we need to demonstrate research carried out by Anne Thorndike. Anne Thorndike, a primary care physician at Massachusetts General Hospital in Boston, had a crazy idea. She believed she could improve the eating habits of thousands of hospital staff and visitors without changing their willpower or motivation in the slightest way. In fact, she didn't plan on talking to them at all.

She designed a six-month study where she altered ‘choice architecture’ of the hospital cafeteria. Originally, the refrigerators were filled with bottles of soda. Unlike this plan, they added water bottles as an option with soda bottles. Additionally, they placed baskets of bottled waters in different parts of the cafeteria. Over, the next three months sales of bottled water increased by 25.8% while the sale of soda decreased by 11.4%. Astonishingly, no dweller in the cafeteria was aware of this idea. This shows that habit change depends on the cues presented before an individual. Similarly, putting forth alluring cues before individuals creates a room for habit change, without they themselves noticing it. Hence, it would not be fallacious to hypothesize that motivation just exaggerates while the environment inhabited by mankind and the cues they encounter, impacts on the habit of the individual.

Similarly, the applications we design must present alluring cues to the individuals, which intensify their fascination about culture. There are several features that emphasize the richness of our culture. The features include:

Track routine:

Our primogenitors have formulated a flourishing routine which assures healthy life and personal development. They mention the particular time at which the activities must be carried out. Waking early is considered to be a healthy habit. This is because human brain is highly productive early in the morning. This also boosts the concentration power. This being an instance there are several other practices taught by our ancestors. They are immensely effectual in bringing changes in one’s life. Hence, people should be guided about such exemplary routine and inspire them to follow it. But imposing all the habits together into the life of the individual may lead to a scenario of being ineffectual

in practicing those. Therefore, the app we design must understand the present routine of the person and gradually suggest practicable changes. Eventually, the app will be successful in bringing about significant changes in people's life progressively. These suggestions may include the benefit of practicing it. This makes the person enthusiastic about following it.

Track Food Habits:

Our ancient civilization had a flawless food pattern. They categorized food into three divisions based on the psychological effects experienced after consuming them. They are: Saattvika, Rajasika, Tamasika. The Saattvika foods enhance the perspective abilities (knowledge, memory, learning ability). The food products such as cow's milk, fruits, wheat, honey, etc., fall under the category of Saattvika foods. Some researchers suggest the link between such food and serotonin production. Serotonin is one of the chemicals in brain that initiate happy mood. The Rajasika food triggers our activity levels (physical and mental work). This category includes foods like salt, Chillies, Tamarind and Pickles. The Tamasika foods increase laziness (sleep, sloth, boredom). Onion, Garlic, tobacco, beef, wine, etc. The merits of this highly scientific food pattern must be explained to people. The app we design, should priorly throw light on benefits of this classification. Then the app must help people to gradually abdicate unhealthy food. Suggestions about healthy food should be given through this app. By this people will develop healthy food habits and embrace culture as well.

Articles:

There are many innovative writers who glorify the rich culture through their writing. Their writings can be

published in the app. The users will be able to access them and acquire knowledge about the traditions.

Notifications:

Notification is an intrinsic portion of apps. Every app uses notifications. They vary based on the working of the app. In the following app people can be notified about some processes attributed to culture. This may include:

1. The app should notify facts every-day. These can be those facts that intrigue one's interest about culture.
2. We earlier mentioned that we can devise a section of articles about culture. People should be notified whenever new articles are posted.
3. Similar to many news aggregator apps, this app must provide updates about daily occurrences that glorify culture. This helps the person to continuously be in contact of the app.

There must be addition of other enhanced features through which people can share the way they embrace their culture. The individuals tend to make changes in their life and revisit their enriched culture without any deliberation. This is possible because human brain adapts to the cue presented before the individual. Launching such apps draws the attention of people, thereby, finding place in their devices. The app presents alluring facts and cues propelling the multitude to introduce practices in their own life. This may sound like implausible project. However, the technological world has a praiseworthy expertise to achieve victory in such tasks.

Digital media has a significant influence on humankind. This is an integral part of modern society. Humankind has equipped spectacular technology in modern times. And they have been brought up under the mastery of grand culture. There should be an equilibrium between modern

implements and cultural beliefs in order to lead a peaceful life. This is not possible due to ill effects of digital media over culture. Such effects can be reversed by employing digital media as chief source of promoting culture. We must design the app that works on the principle of minute changes magnificent result. It also helps in reviving the zeal for culture. It would not be fallacious to hypothesize that we can get back to our roots by devising such platforms in the digital world.

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4. GENDER STUDIES

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ABSTRACT

Gender studies are a disciplinary field of study that analysis the social construction and cultural significance of gender, survey how it from individuals, experiences, identities and relationships. The abstract gives an overview of key themes and approaches in gender studies; best part is importance in understanding power dynamics, social inequalities, and diverse forms of gender expression.

This report aims to provide extensive analysis of gender dynamics, examining the social, cultural and psychological aspects that shape gender identities and roles. The report addresses key problem related to gender equality, gender – based discrimination, and the impact of gender norms on individuals and societies.

GENDER ROLES IN PRE-MODERN SOCIETIES

Division of labour:- In pre-modern societies often had distinct gender based divisions of labor. Men were responsible for activities such as hunting, warfare, agriculture, and trade, while women were engaged in domestic works like child rearing, cooking, weaving, and gathering. This role was often based on the physical differences between men and women.

Power and authority:- In most pre-modern society, men have position of power and authority. Political leadership, decision-making, and public roles were predominantly occupied by men. Women's roles in governance and decision-making were limited, although there were exceptions in some matrilineal societies, where women held significant social and political influences.

Patriarchy:- Most of pre-modern society were patriarchal, means that men held primary positions of power and responsibility. Men predominantly occupied political, economic, and religious leadership roles, while women had limited access of position of influence and decision-making.

Reproduction and Family:- Women's reproductive roles were highly valued in pre-modern society due to the importance of maintaining family times and ensuring the continuity of the community or society. Women were typically expected to marry, bear children, and full fill the maternal duties, which were considered their primary social roles.

Clothing and Appearance:- Dress codes and styles varied across cultures, but in many pre-modern societies, there were distinct clothing norms for men and women. Men often wore practical and functional attire suited for their roles in activities like hunting or warfare, while women's clothing was more modest and focused on modesty and domestically.

GENDER IDENTITY DEVELOPMENT

Early childhood:- At a young age, children begin to develop a basic understanding of gender. They may start to recognize differences between boys and girls, such as

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physical appearances and societal expectations. During this stage, children often exhibit gender-stereotypical behaviors and preferences, such as girls gravitating toward dolls and boys showing interest in trucks.

Gender Stability (preschool age):-Around the age of 3 to 5, children typically acquire a firmer grasp on gender stability. They understand that their gender does not change over time, even if their gender does not change over time, even if their outward appearance or activities may differ. Children may develop a strong sense of belonging to their gender group and show preferences for playing with same-gender peers.

Gender identity formation (adolescence):-During adolescence, individuals undergo significant psychological and emotional changes. This period is crucial for the development of a more complex and nuanced gender identity. Adolescents may explore and question their gender identity, sometimes experiencing feelings of gender dysphoria, if their gender identity does not align with their assigned sex at birth.

Gender Constancy (school age):-As children reach school age (around 6 to 7 years old), they begin to grasp the concept of gender remains consistent regardless of changes in appearance or behavior. At this stage, children may display stronger adherence to gender stereotypes and become more aware of societal expectations related to gender roles.

GENDER SELF-PERCEPTION

Gender Identity:-Gender identity refers to an individual's deeply felt sense of their assigned sex at birth or not gender identity influences how individuals perceive themselves

and how they relate to others. Developing a positive and authentic gender identity is crucial for a healthy sense of self.

Self-concept:-Gender is an essential aspect of an individual's self –concept, which encompasses the beliefs, attitudes, and evaluations they hold about themselves. One's gender identity is a central component of their self-concept, shaping their understanding of who they are and influencing their thought, feeling, and behavior.

Intersectionally:-Gender intersects with other aspects of identity, such as race, ethnicity, sexuality, and socio-economic status. The intersectionality of these identities can influence an individual's self-perception and experiences, as they navigate multiple social categories and face unique challenges and privileges associated with each.

Self-acceptance and empowerment:-Developing a positive self-perception regarding gender involves self-acceptance, self –discovery, and embracing one's authentic identity. It is essential for individuals to feel affirmed and supported in their gender identity, allowing them to cultivate self-confidence, resilience, and empowerment.

TRANS GENDER AND NON-BINARY EXPERIENCES

Gender identity:-Gender identity is a deeply felt sense of being male, female, or something else. For transgender individuals their gender identity does not match the sex, they were assigned at birth. Non-binary individuals, on the other hand, may identify as neither exclusively male nor female, or as a combination of both.

Challenges and Discrimination:-Transgender and non-binary individuals often face unique challenges and discrimination. They may encounter prejudice, stigma, and social rejection from family, friends, colleagues, and society. Transgender and non-binary individuals are also at a higher risk of experiencing mental health issues, including depression and anxiety because of social marginalization.

Legal Rights and Protections:-The legal rights and protections for transgender and non-binary individuals vary across countries and regions. Some jurisdictions have enacted laws to protect transgender and non-binary people discrimination in areas such as employment, housing, healthcare, and education. However, many places still lack comprehensive legal protections, leaving transgender and non-binary individuals vulnerable to discrimination and mistreatment.

Support and Advocacy:-Supportive environments, access to affirming healthcare, mental health services, and inclusive policies are vital for promoting the well-being and rights of transgender and non-binary individuals. Allies can play a crucial role in advocating for transgender and non-binary rights, challenging stereotypes, and creating inclusive spaces that value and respect gender diversity.

GENDER BASED VIOLENCE AND HEALTH IMPLICATIONS.

Gender based violence :-(GBV) is a pervasive issue that affects millions of people in worldwide. It refers to any form of violence or abuse, including physical, sexual, psychological, and economic violence that occurs primarily

because of an individual gender. Women and girls are often the most affected by GBV. However, men and boys can also be victims. GBV as severe as health implication for survivors, and it can affect various aspects of their physical and mental well-being. Here are some of the health implications associated with gender-based violence.

Physical injuries:-GBV can cause immediate physical injuries such as bruises, cuts, fracture, and internal injuries. In extreme cases, it may lead to life-threatening injuries and death.

Mental Health Disorder:-GBV can have a significant psychological effect, leading to mental health disorders such as depression, anxiety, and post-traumatic stress disorders (PTSD), and Suicidal thoughts.

Segmentation and Isolation:- Survivors of GBV may face societal stigma and isolation, which can further affect their mental and emotional well-being.

Impact on children and families:- GBV not only affects the survivors but can also have lasting impact on their children and families, creating and a cycle of violence and adverse and health outcomes for future generation.

CONCLUSION

Gender studies are a vital field of academic inquiries that examine the complexities of gender and its impact on individual, societies, and cultures. Through non-disciplinary approach, gender studies sheds light on the social construction of gender, the intersectionality of identities, and the various system of power of oppression that influence gender studies.

References:

- As the last update in September, there are several reference books that provide comprehensive insights into gender studies.
- “Gender Trouble: feminism and the subversion of identity” by Judith Butler
- “The second sex” by Simone de Beauvoir
- “Feminism is for everybody: passionate politics” by Bell hooks
- “Whipping Girl: A transsexual woman on sexism and the femininity” by Patricia Hill Collins

5. CONTRIBUTION OF WOMEN WRITERS TO DALIT LITERATURE

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Dalit literature is a genre of Indian writing that focuses on the lives, experiences, and struggles of the Dalit community, who have faced caste-based oppression and discrimination for centuries. As Jobymon Skaria explains, “Dalit literature has been the most potent literary expression of Dalits’ daily struggle for human dignity. This literature encompasses various Indian languages such as Marathi, Bangla, Hindi, Kannada, Punjabi, Sindhi, Odia and Tamil and includes diverse narratives like poems, short stories, and autobiographies. The movement originated in response to the caste-based social injustices in mid-twentieth-century independent India and has spread across various Indian languages, critiquing caste practices and experimenting with different literary forms.

Prominent works within Dalit literature emerged in the colonial and post-colonial period, with Jyotirao Phule’s *Gulamgiri*, published in 1873, being a seminal work highlighting the plight of the Untouchables in India. Numerous authors, such as Sharankumar Limbale, Namdeo Dhasal, and Bama, have contributed to the Dalit literary movement, each offering unique perspectives on the Dalit experience. The Dalit Panther movement in Maharashtra and the influence of Dr. B.R. Ambedkar, an advocate for Dalit rights, has played significant roles in shaping Dalit literature across India.

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Dalit literature has also been instrumental in the development of Dalit feminism, with the autobiographies and testimonies of Dalit women authors emphasizing the intersection of caste, class, and gender in the context of social exclusion. Prominent Dalit women authors, such as Urmila Pawar and Baby Kamble, have shed light on the struggles of their communities, providing a foundation for understanding the complexities of caste, class, and gender in Indian society.

Bama Faustina Susairaj

'Karukku'(1992), the most famous book written in Tamil is an autobiographical account of her childhood experiences of being a Dalit. In her book she tries to bring about an awakening in Dalit women to empower them with education through her experiences. This book led to her being ostracized from her village as it critiques the social order but however gained critical acclaim. Her style of writing was noticed as being unique and other unique feature being that she does not name the protagonist. Never miss real stories from India's women.

Yashica Dutt

An Indian journalist and writer, Yashica Dutt belongs to a Dalit family from Ajmer. Alumni of St. Stephens College, New Delhi and Columbia University USA, she has written frequently about the issues faced by Dalits. She has freelanced for numerous well-known newspapers and magazines in India. After the suicide of University student Rohit Vemula, she realized that she was no longer comfortable hiding her identity as a Dalit and hence wrote a memoir called Coming Out as Dalit. It is been well received memoir, she shares her

personal experience about being a Dalit and how she used to hide it and how she came to terms with her identity. She has also started a Tumblr portal called dalit discrimination. tumblr.com to raise awareness regarding the issue of discrimination against Dalits.

Urmila Pawar

Urmila Pawar was born into the Hindu Mahar family in Maharashtra. She has an MA in Marathi Literature and retired from PWD department of the state of Maharashtra. She converted into Buddhism when she was 12 at behest of Babasaheb Ambedkar's country wide call for renouncing in 1956. Her moving to Mumbai in 1976 marked her discovery of feminism. These two important events shaped her life and writing. Other works of Urmila Pawar are collection of short stories which are witty Mother wit and We Also Made History: Women in the Ambedkarite Movement. All her books are critically acclaimed and have a unique witty style of writing.

Meena Kandasamy

Meena Kandasamy is an Indian feminist poet, writer and translator. While she was in college, she started translating the works of Dalit women around her. Her poems and writings are predominantly centered on feminism and caste reform in the modern day India. Her poem Ms. Militancy showcases the journey of Kannagi the protagonist of the Tamil epic Silappathikaram delivering a message of women's unbounded daring. She has also authored a biography on Dalit social reformer from Kerala Ayyankali called Ayyankali: A Dalit leader of Organic Protest. One of her recent and most well-known works is the novel 'When I

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Hit You' showing the violence and isolation a young women faces from her husband.

Babytai Kamble

Her book Jina Amacha/The Prisons We Broke is the depiction of Dalit women of Mahar community and their tribulations. She was born to a comfortable working class household. Her father was a labor contractor who used to do contracts for the government. Though belonging to the Mahar community she led a fairly comfortable life. She also married into a similar Mahar family and bore 10 children. Despite her comfortable stature her books talk about the poverty and filth faced in general by the community. She later became an activist, fighting for the cause of her community. She ran an ashram for backward children till her death in 2012.

Kalyani Thakur Charal

Kalyani Thakur Charal not only writes herself, but has also provided a platform for other Dalit women writers, as the editor of the Dalit women's magazine, Neer. She is part of the editorial board of Chaturtha Duniya, a publishing house focused solely on the works of Dalit writers. She is also a board member of the recently formed Dalit Sahitya Akademi. And, of course, she is an activist who has lent her voice to a wide range of issues including the Citizenship Amendment Act (CAA) and the National Register of Citizens (NRC).

She has recently edited and written in Stree-Samya publication's offering Dalit Lekhika – Women's Writings from Bengal, along with Sayantan Dasgupta, that removes any misconceptions we may have that caste brutality does

not belong in today's world. The pieces in this compilation are written by a current generation of Dalit women writer.

Maroona Murmu

Maroona Murmu is an associate professor in the Department of History at Jadavpur University, Kolkata. Her book 'Words of Her Own': Women Authors in Nineteenth-Century Bengal explores the idea and articulation of emerging women writers in nineteenth-century Bengal. Maroona Murmu grew up as a daughter of a Bengali-Hindu woman and a Santhal man from Belpahari in Medinipore. She was often the subject of questions about her ethnicity to being questioned about belonging to a Scheduled Tribe- she faced it in almost all frontiers of her life.

Sukirtharini

Sukirtharini is a feminist poet, and she is widely acclaimed for her contribution to Dalit and Tamil literature. She is a Tamil teacher at the Governments Girls High School in Vellore, Tamil Nadu. She has a master's degree in economics and Tamil literature. Her works have revolved around the idea of the female body as the chastisement of the oppressive caste system. This idea comes from a deep perspective about being born both a female and a Dalit.

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6. DALIT LITERATURE: EXPLORING THE DEVELOPMENT OF A COHESIVE DALIT IDENTITY

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Caste-based society is one of India's most recognizable characteristics. Shudras, also referred to as Dalits, have long been considered untouchables. This disadvantaged, estranged, backward, and underprivileged minority has long stood apart from the rest of human society. From an identity issue, they have been alienating people. They have been striving for their identity over time, either by converting to other religions or by rebelling against the Hindu religion's Varna strata. Several well-known social reformers, like Jyotiba Phule, Sabitribai Phule, Ambedkar, and others, battle for the Dalit community's equal rights and identity. Thus, the writings ultimately emphasize the notion that Dalits have a unique voice for asserting their individuality through their own literature, proving that the underprivileged can also speak.

The current research examines the manner by which Dalits have attempted to construct and articulate their group identity when making their claims. It also makes the case that the extremely varied narrative tenors in the Dalit writings reflect the various stages of the Dalit liberation movement's development following India's independence. By reflecting on the various literatures, this will finally show

how these literatures offer various perspectives with regard to the development of a cohesive Dalit identity.

After its independence from Britain in 1947, India enacted a constitutional democracy with universal adult suffrage. Yet, the concept of political democracy was at odds with an unequal and undemocratic social reality. A tiny group of upper caste elites who cemented their position inside the state and its numerous structures like the bureaucracy, monopolised power during the colonial era.

The Indian National Congress, usually known as Congress, was mostly a higher castes and notables' party that dominated the country for the first two decades after independence. To continue to hold onto its power, the House engaged in client list and vertical politics. It permitted the admission of political figures from the upper caste people who, in return for access to public finances, utilized their influence as local notables, moneylenders, or landlords to influence favour and voting for the party (Jaffrelot 48, 49 and 66). The bulk of the lower caste and other sections of the plebeian population were pushed out of the political power despite the fact that the all- inclusive Indian Constitution was progressive and required that all people had the equal rights to hold public office.

The architects of the Indian Constitution, especially Jawaharlal Nehru, the nation's first prime minister, thought that the adoption of a contemporary, secular democracy, rapid industrialisation, and planned government growth would lead to individuality and anonymity. Under the strain of these forces, it was projected that one of the outdated, communal systems, caste, would collapse. (Kaviraj 102).

Nehru and the Constitution's authors were socialists who were familiar with the concepts of western liberal ideology and were influenced by it. They understood that the modern State and industrialization had individuated society, making

the individual the most significant social unit around which life was organised. They anticipated a similar development in India. But modernists like Nehru failed to understand how traditions could change in reaction to historical events. Moreover, social stratification was organised in the West around the subject of class. Class-based groups were ephemeral, and each one's composition varied over time as a result of varying economic conditions. On the other hand, the caste enumeration carried out by the ethnographic colonial power created and strengthened the permanence and makeup of caste- based groups (Kaviraj 103 and 110).

Caste could not be eradicated in post-colonial India as a result. In reality, caste began to gradually organise social life and politics in India after the country attained independence. In the 1970's, when lower castes began to politically organise themselves, the Congress and the upper caste elites faced a severe challenge to their political dominance. The upper castes had supremacy over the State and its resources; therefore the counter-hegemonic movement was defined in terms of lower caste affiliation rather than in terms of abstract individual citizenship rights. (Witsoe 19).

Due to the 'impure' labour that Dalits performed, such as burying the dead, laundering garments soaked in menstrual blood, skinning dead animals, etc. as required by the caste system, they were viewed as untouchables and outside the Varna system. Since the mere shadow of members of some Dalit castes was regarded by those from the upper castes as "polluting," they were compelled to live beyond the bounds of village life since they were thought to have become "polluted" by performing these "impure" occupations.

The Hindu philosopher Manu wrote the work Manusmriti, which outlines the caste system's rules and the proper interactions between caste members. While caste persisted in Hindu society prior to the Manusmriti's compilation, the

institution of caste system was only established through its compilation, according to Ambedkar. (Dangle XX).

However, Untouchability as a practice was outlawed and made a crime in India after the Indian Constitution was adopted in 1950. Also, under Article 16.4 of the Indian Constitution, 15% of positions in the public sector and in state-funded institutions of higher learning are allocated for members of the Scheduled Castes (Dalits) (Desai and Kulkarni 2008). By these reservation regulations, a very small percentage of Dalits were able to achieve some degree of social and economic mobility and started organising for the social advancement and political empowerment of Dalits.

Etymologically speaking, the word Dalit is a Marathi word which means broken down. The word does not occur in the Constitution of India, and it is used by Dalits to refer and assert them politically. Through the usage of this word Dalits refer to themselves as broken people who have been broken due to thousands of years of caste discrimination. It is difficult to ascertain who used the word for the first time since we find the existence of words like padadalit (crushed by foot) and Dalit even before India's independence. However, it could be stated that the word gained more currency after India's independence when Dalits gradually began to mobilise themselves.

In the cultural sphere Dalit literature became an important vehicle for the self-expression of the political consciousness of Dalits in independent India. While certain critics trace the origins of Dalit literature to the 14th century poet Cokhamela, according to noted Dalit critic Arjun Dangle, the person who paved the path for the development of Modern Dalit literature was Dr. B. R. Ambedkar who was born into the untouchable Mahar caste in Maharashtra, was a prolific writer, erudite scholar and the chairman of

the drafting committee of the Constitution of India (Dangle XXIII).

Dangle (2009: XXIII) further argues that although Ambedkar did not write any literary fiction, and that his writing oeuvre comprises mostly of articles and books dealing with issues of caste and India's anti-colonial movement. Yet, Ambedkar by effectively mobilising Dalits towards the cause of their emancipation paved the path towards the acquisition of political consciousness among them which was later on found expression in the writings of Dalit writers and poets. In independent India Dalit literature emerged first in Marathi in Maharashtra. The first Dalit literary conference was organised in 1958 by the Maharashtra Dalit Sahitya Sangha. The conference discussed the aims and objectives of Dalit literature in detail and passed a resolution that stated "the literature written by the Dalits in Marathi [must] be accepted as a separate entity known as "Dalit literature" and realising its cultural importance, the universities and literary organisations should give it its proper place (Prabuddha Bharat 1958 cited in Dangle 1999: XXVIII). Dangle (1999: XXII) himself describes the purpose of Dalit literature in the following lines, "This literature [Dalit literature] is closely associated with the hopes for freedom of a group of people who as untouchables are victims of social, economic and cultural inequality. Their literature is thus characterised by a feeling of rebellion against the establishment, of negativism and scientificity".

The history of Dalit and other marginal literatures may be traced to Karl Marx's philosophical ideas which strongly influenced the dialectical philosophy of writers in the 19th century. Marx's theory that every society in history had an economic base upon which every other aspect of human life was dependent acts as the backdrop of these literatures. The Marxist literary theory postulated that the cultural element

of a society- its art and literature was dependent upon and reflected its economic base (Goulimari 108).

The Marxist literary theorists referred to this domain of culture as the superstructure of a society which was totally dependent upon the base. From here, Marxist literary critics developed a literary theory called socialist realism. The term referred to literary and artistic works that accurately portrayed the existing realities of the society and upheld the Marxist idea of the conflict between the bourgeoisie and the proletariat, which eventually would lead to the formation of a classless, communist society (Abrams and Harpham 368). The Russian novelist Maxim Gorky's novel *Mother* is usually considered one of the first literary works written in the tradition of socialist realism. While the literary or classical realism of 19th century Victorian writers was concerned only with the truthful reflection of their existing societies, the Marxist concept of socialist realism was not just content with truthful representations but would also require portraying how these existing conditions could be transcended through class conflict leading eventually to the formation of a classless society.

In the cultural sphere, Dalit thinkers and critics began to debate and discuss questions pertaining to what comprised and what could be defined as Dalit literature, which had the right to speak on behalf of Dalits, etc. The noted Dalit critic Sharankumar Limbale observes that the representation of Dalits in literary texts has passed through three stages: erasure, containment and finally assertion (Mukherjee 5). In the period of erasure, Dalit characters are absent in the texts written by upper-caste writers. It is as if Dalit life and Dalits were not worthy enough of being mentioned in these literary texts. As Mukherjee (2004: 5) writes, "It would appear that the upper caste Hindus achieved in literature what they could not in real life, namely, a complete silencing,

if not erasure, of the untouchable Other with no chance of being polluted by the untouchables shadow”.

From here, the representation of Dalits moves to a phase which Limbale refers to as containment. In this phase, Dalit characters appeared, not as self-owning subjects, but as objects of pity for the upper castes. The focus in these writings was still very much upon the representation of the upper-castes, and the reformation they were undergoing, so that they could treat the Dalits with sympathy and not oppress them. Mukherjee (2004: 5) writes, “Unable to imagine the untouchable Other out of existence, Brahminical literature now sought to confine it within a discourse marked by sympathy and compassion.” Examples of writings of this kind include Mulk Raj Anand’s *The Untouchable*, U. R. Ananthamurthy’s *Samskara* and *Bharathipura*, etc. Eventually, Dalit literature entered the phase of assertion. In this phase, Dalit writers began to write about themselves and their societies. The reason why Dalit writers could finally do that was due to the transformative impact brought about by the reservation policies, and the electoral victories of political parties based around a Dalit identity.

These Dalit writers focused on the lives of Dalits and their oppressive experiences due to the persistence of caste, and not on how upper-caste people were trying to reform themselves. Autobiographies became one of the first modes through which Dalits began to assert themselves in the domain of literature. As Beth (2007: 547) argues: “Dalit autobiographies role in informing public perception of Dalit life has meant that the dramatic increase of this autobiographical literature in Hindi since the 1980s has led to an important shift in the conceptualization of Dalit identity”.

Finally, this leaves us with the questions of how does one theorise and resolve the problem of Dalit identity, and

how we could theorise a Dalit identity considering all its inherent contradictions and conflicts. It might also be asked whether such a resolution is even required at all. This is because, most oppressed identity groups are engaged in an ongoing and continuous process of imagining and re-imagining their identities taking into account its inherent contradictions. This process of imagining and re-imagining is what ultimately allows it to make citizenship claims upon the State.

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7. FOLK LITERATURE

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ABSTRACT

Folk literature encompasses a rich and diverse body of oral and written narratives passed down through generations within a particular culture or community. It includes various forms of storytelling such as folktales, myths, legends, fables, and ballads that serve as repositories of cultural heritage and collective wisdom. This abstract provides an overview of the key characteristics and themes found in folk literature across different cultures.

One of the defining features of folk literature is its tradition, where stories are transmitted orally from one generation to another generation. The abstract of folk literature encapsulates the essence and characteristics of this genre, highlighting its significance and distinctive features. It emphasizes the oral tradition and communal nature of folk literature, which often serves as a reflection of the beliefs, values, and customs. One characteristic of folk literature is its oral tradition, which involves storytelling and performance passed on from one generation to next.

INTRODUCTION

Folk literature is a captivating and essential part of human cultural heritage, encompassing a rich tapestry of traditional stories, songs, myths, and customs passed down orally from generation to next. It is the product of ancient storytelling, crafted by the collective wisdom, imagination, and experience of various societies throughout history.

Which emerged with the advent of writing systems, folk literature predates recorded history. It embodies the essence of the human experience, reflecting the beliefs, values, and cultural identity of different communities through folk literature, people have sought to make sense of the world around them, explain natural phenomena, understand the mysteries of life and death and impart moral lessons to future generations.

FOLK LITERATURE TAKES ON DIVERSE FORMS

Folk Tales:- These are enchanting narratives that often include magical elements, talking animals, and extraordinary heroes and heroines. Folk tales can be moral story teaching valuable lessons or cautionary tales to install cultural norms and societal values.

Myths:- Myths are sacred stories that offer explanation for the creation of the world, the origin of humanity, and the existence of natural phenomena. They often feature gods, goddesses, and legendary figures whose actions shape the course of human history.

Folk songs and Ballads:- Songs and ballads are a musical expression of folk literature. They provide an emotional

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connection to a community history, recounting love, loss, heroes, and significant events ballads, in particular, are narrative songs that re-count tragic tales and adventures.

Folk lore Creatures:- Folk literature introduce a host of mythical creatures and begins, from majestic dragons and mischievous fairies to fearsome monsters and benevolent spirits. These beings embody the fears, hopes and dreams of the cultures that created them.

Folk rituals and festivals:- Folk literature is often intertwined with cultural rituals and festivals, influencing how communities celebrate and mark significant occasions, such as births, weddings, harvests, and rites of passage.

Oral tradition and storytelling:- The oral tradition is the heart of folk literature. Storytellers, griot, shamans and bards play a vital role in preserving and passing down these narratives across generations.

Preservation's of cultural identity, knowledge, and traditions:- It connects people to their roots, fostering a sense of belonging and shared history. By studying folk literature, researchers and enthusiasts gain profound insights into the beliefs, customs, and world views of ancient and contemporary cultures alike.

In an ever-changing world, the importance of preserving folk literature cannot be understated. It allows us to understand and appreciate the diverse ways in which human societies have interpreted and navigated life's challenges and wonders throughout times. As we delve into the captivating world of folk literature, we discover the timeless stories and beauty of these timeless stories and their enduring impact on the human experience.

Examples of folk literature: Example #1: Rudyard Kipling

Rudyard Kipling was keenly interested in folktale, as he has written many English works based on folktale such as, 'Reward and Fairies' and 'Puck of Polk's Hill'. His experiences of Indian environment have led him to create several works about Indian themes and tradition. Since Kipling has lived a great deal of life in India regions, he was much familiar with the Indian languages.

Kipling's popular work, 'The Jungle Book', consists of plenty of stories about traditional folktales. He also has Indian themes in his work and stories, in which he has given many characters recognizable names related to Indian languages. Helen Bannerman has also penned an Indian themed folktale, 'Little Black Samba', during the same period.

Example #2: Patrick Henry

Patrick Henry was a politician, attorney and planter, who gained popularity as an orator when Americans were struggling for independence. He is well known for his speech in the House of Burgesses in 1775 in the church of Saint Joseph. The House was undecided about whether they need to mobilize and take military action against encroaching military forces of England. Henry gave his arguments in favor of American forces mobilization.

Example #3: A. k. Ramanujan

A. K. Ramanujan has written a lot about context sensitivity as a theme in many cultural essays, classical poetry, and is Indian folklore. For example, in his works 'Three Hundred Ramayana's', and where 'Mirrors Are Windows', he talks about inter textual and oral Indian literature. His popular

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essay, were Mirrors Are Windows: Toward an Anthology of Reflections, and commentaries done on Indian folktales, including Oral Tales from Twenty Indian Languages, and The Interior Land scope: Love Poems from a Classical Tamil Anthology, present perfect examples of Indian folk literature studies.

CONCLUSION

Folk literature is a rich and diverse form of cultural expression that has captivated audiences throughout history. Moreover, folk literature has a significant impact on contemporary literature and media. Many popular novels, movies, and televisions shows draw inspiration from traditional folktales and myths, breathing new life into these ancient stories and ensuring their relevance in modern society. In conclusion, folk literature is a treasure trove of human imagination and wisdom that transcends geographical and temporal boundaries. Its enduring appeal lies in its ability to entertain, educate, and connect people from diverse backgrounds. As long as there are storytellers to keep tales alive, folk literature will continue to enchant and inspire generations to come.

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**8. SOCIO-CULTURAL
REPRESENTATION IN LITERATURE
AND CINEMA
SAMSKARA BY U.R.ANANTHAMURTHY**

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A set of beliefs, customs, practices and behaviour that exists within a population contributes to the social and cultural representation of that society. Two ideas that surface repeatedly in literature are representation and resistance. We judge a novel or a poem by how adequately it represents the indigenous people, their culture etc. It will be clear by now that the present question of place-language relation is part of another “twist in the study of literature”, the growing concern after the linguistic and cultural turns particularly in literature and movies. The immediate sensitive relation with the changes turns out to have stolen the reader’s and viewer’s attention! In this regard, I have chosen the literary text Samskara, a Kannada novel by U.R. Ananthamurthy which has been made into a movie by the same title directed by Pattabhirama Reddy.

Samskara is both a character study and the exploration of the socio-cultural state at the same time. This important Kannada novel of the sixties has received widespread acclaim from both critics and general readers, since its first publication in 1965. As a religious novel about a decaying Brahmin colony in the South-Indian village of Karnataka. Samskara serves an allegory rich in realistic detail, a contemporary reworking of ancient Hindu themes, myths

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and a serious poetic study of religious men living in a community of priests gone to seed.

Samskara is set in Durvasapura, an Agrahara, a closed-off Brahmin community that lives according to tightly and ultimately suffocating circumscribed rules and norms, the weight of tradition now crushing a community that is unable to adapt. The story begins with the death of Naranappa, a long thorn in the side of community as he had undermined the local ways at every possible way, he nevertheless had not been ex-communicated and was still a relative or if need be, another brahmin. However, Naranappa was-“a smear on the good of the agrahara” no one wants to associate them with performing the ritual rites for him. Matters are further complicated by Naranappa’s concubine Chandri throwing her gold jewellery into the ring as it were, offering it to anyone willing to perform the rites.

The community looks to Praneshacharya- not yet forty, but the most learned and devoted Brahmin and treated like the local wise old man-to find a solution, trusting him to get this important matter right (and reminding him; “that brahminism of your entire sect is in your hands, your burden is great.”) Praneshacharya is paralysed by the issue; he carries his own burden too. His wife of twenty years is invalid, so in some respects he has not been able to live the life expected of him, either no sex, no family beyond the ill wife and clearly the rigid rules of this community leave him feeling boxed in.

It is Chandri, who takes matters into her own hands again in dealing with what becomes of Naranappa. Praneshacharya’s inability to make a decision is, in a way, ultimately freeing. He has failed, but Chandri’s solution is presumably good. Praneshacharya, the embodiment of a real brahmin ultimately

fails to fully live up to the exacting standards of caste. The rot is evident throughout Samskara too, beyond just the moral rot with the decomposition. Sanskara is an effective tale of community choked by unsustainable tradition, a dead body and the rats and cockroaches. Death is pervasive too as the plague sweeps through the area. Naranappa is not the only one to die; others in the community also are succumbing to death. Ananthamurthy offers fine portrayal of a variety of characters as they struggle between natural urges and social expectations and has crafted an impressive story here. Praneshacharya, long devoted entirely to the caste and tradition is forced by circumstances to question it. Freed over the cause of the story, from several of his burdens. However Ananthamurthy does not offer a solution here. Hence, Samskara remains open ended.

SAMSKARA is a 1970's Kannada film written by U.R.Ananthamurthy, directed by Pattabhirama Reddy. It is said to have been a path-breaking venture and is supposed to have pioneered the parallel cinema movement in Kannada films. The word Samskara means ritual in Kannada language. Singeetam Srinivas Rao was the Executive Director. Samskara garnered the National Film Award for Best Feature Film in 1970. The story written by U.R.Ananthamurthy in 1965, when he was studying at the University of Birmingham for his Ph.D. He saw the film "The seventh seal" by Ingmar Bergman and was deeply moved by it. His tutor Malcolm Bradbury suggests writing about his experiences in India concerning the multilayered structure of time in Indian society. After completing the story, he sent the manuscript to Girish Karnad in India, who got in touch with Pattabhirama Reddy and came up with a film script for the same. Samskara was the first Kannada film to be directed and produced by Pattabhirama Reddy who had

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mainly dealt with Telugu films. A visiting Australian camera man Tom Cowan, was selected to shoot it. The film was shot in a village in the Shimoga district of Karnataka.

The story is set in a street in a small village called Durvasapura in the western ghats of Karnataka. A majority of the people who live in the street belong to the community of Madhwas (a Brahmin community). The people who stay there have a traditional mindset and strictly follow the rules defined by their religion. Two of the main characters in the story are Praneshacharya played by Girish Karnad and Naranappa. Praneshacharya is a devote Brahmin who has completed Vedic education at Varanasi, has returned to Durvasapura and is considered as the leader of the Brahmin community in his village and the surrounding ones. His main goal is to attain liberation (moksha) and he is willing to go to any length to achieve it. To remain focused on his goal and as an act of self-sacrifice, he married an invalid woman and hence remains celibate. The other main character Naranappa, a Brahmin by birth but one who has rejected the set of rules of brahminism by eating meat and by keeping the company of a prostitute named Chandri. Once, Naranappa and his friends catch fishes in the temple tank cook and eat them! This causes the Brahmins in the villages to rise up against him. They approach Praneshacharya to throw him out of the village. Praneshacharya decides against taking his extreme step and he believes that Naranappa can be convinced to get rid of his immoral acts. Once Naranappa visits Shimoga and he returns to Durvasapura with high fever and dies. The Brahmins are left in a piquant situation because according to Brahmin principals, a person who dies should be cremated as early as possible. None of the Brahmins wants to cremate the body- they feel that by cremating Naranappa's body, they will become polluted as he was against Brahmin

principles during his life.

However, the Brahmin principles also stipulate that a non-brahmin cannot cremate the body of a Brahmin. Praneshacharya being the leader is responsible for finding the answer to this difficult situation. He reads the holy books but they do not provide any solution. He then goes to a temple to pray to God and spends the whole day there. Disappointed at not being able to solve the problem, he trudges back home. On his way, he encounters Chandri, is mesmerized by her beauty and when he wakes up in the middle of the night, he finds himself lying on Chandri's lap! Chandri rushes home finds that Naranappa's body has begun to rot, gets it cremated in secrecy and leaves Durvasapura. Praneshacharya left in a piquant situation on whether he should reveal his immoral act to the people or keep quiet about it. Feeling guilty, he leaves the village but the guilt never leaves him. Finally decides to own up to his act, he returns to his village and the story ends here. It's left to the imagination of the viewer on whether Praneshacharya own up for his act or not.

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9. PRESENTATION OF FEMME FATALE IN FILMS PONNIYIN SELVAN PART 1&2

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ABSTRACT

Films are considered to be as one of the most influential and wide spread media in the contemporary world. Moreover than a medium of entertainment, films play a pivotal role in presenting the society through various views. Through the course of time, film grew from a medium of entertainment to be the part of Culture. It also has a strong influence on

the audience.

The presentation of female characters in Indian films is changing according to the periods. In the initial stages of Indian cinema, it was evident that the female characters did not get enough importance. The aristocratic approach of the writers and directors of that period were largely focused on the male characters. But this phallogentric approach towards cinema had changed. Many strong female characters have been shown in the big screen and these characters were widely praised. Directors and writers portrayed various shades of the female characters, their thoughts, their emotions, their struggles and so on. There are female characters who are strong antagonist, thus showing the audience that even women can portray strong and cruel villains.

Here we are taking the films *PonniyinSelvan* part 1 and *PonniyinSelvan* part 2, directed by Mani Ratnam, which is based on the novel written by Kalki Krishnamurthy. The primary aim of this paper is focusing particularly on how Mani Ratnam has portrayed the concept of *femme fatale* in his films *PonniyinSelvan* part 1 and *PonniyinSelvan* part 2. *Femme fatale* is a French word which deals with the concept of a stock character of a mysterious, beautiful, and seductive woman whose charms ensnare her lovers, often leading them into compromising, deadly traps. She is an archetype of literature and art.

We can observe that, the character Nandini (Aishwarya Rai Bachchan) is the *Femme fatale* throughout both the films. It can be said so, because, Nandini was on the mission to eradicate the Chola empire and for this she uses her beauty as the main weapon. She marries seduces PeriyaPazhuvettarayar (R. Sarathkumar) who is much older than her who blindly believes what she commands. She also seduces ParthibendranPallavan (VikramPrabhu)

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who also falls for her words. She even managed to Kill AdithaKarikalan (Vikram) who was her lover by inviting him to Kadambur. Karikalan, who knows that Nandini is one of the conspirators and she would kill him and went to Kadambur to his love for Nandini. She even controlled the Pandiya conspirators who did whatever she commanded. We can also see that, all those characters fell for Nandini has either been died or have lost everything in their lives.

In conclusion we can say that director Mani Ratnam has showcased Femme fatale through Nandini in a majestic way, showing us how a woman can eliminate an entire kingdom with her beauty.

Keywords: Femme Fatale, Mani Ratnam, Kalki Krishnamurthy, PonniyinSelvan, Nandini.

FINDINGS AND DISCUSSIONS

PonniyinSelvan part 1 and PonniyinSelvan part 2 are the two films directed by Mani Ratnam in the years 2022 and 2023 respectively. These films are the adaptation of the magnum opus PonniyinSelvan written by Kalki Krishnamurthy in the year 1954. The novel PonniyinSelvan is a perfect example for the mixing of history and fiction. These films deal with the history of Chola dynasty before their golden era. The filmmakers altered some parts of the novel for the purpose of increasing the commercial value. Both parts of the film received great responses from the audience, especially from the Tamil audience and the first part of the film marked as the industry hit of Tamil film industry. The central characters of the film were enacted by Vikram, Karthi, Aishwarya Rai Bachchan, Jayam Ravi, Trisha Krishnan, Prakash Raj, AishwaryaLekshmi, R. Sarathkumar, Jayaram etc.

The concept of femme fatale is evident throughout the films by the character named Nandini (Aishwarya Rai Bachchan) who is known for her beauty and seductive

words. Another important character related to Nandini is her husband PeriyaPazhuvettarayar (R. Sarathkumar). PeriyaPazhuvettarayar, the king of Pazhavur kingdom and the aged brave warrior of the Chola dynasty. He is known for his 64 wounds in his body happened in 24 battles. These wounds are the symbol of PeriyaPazhuvettarayar's bravery. Young Nandini married PeriyaPazhuvettarayar only to fulfill her vengeance towards Chola dynasty for beheading VeeraPandiyan (Nassar) and she succeeded in influencing PeriyaPazhuvettarayar by her words and beauty to destroy Chola dynasty. The character AlwarkkadiyanNambi (Jayaram) gives an introduction to VallavaraiyanVanthiyathevan (Karthi) about Nandini when PeriyaPazhuvettarayar reaches Kadambur that Pazhuvettarayar controls Chola kingdom and his young wife controls him. Even in the meeting of chieftains PeriyaPazhuvettarayar gets questioned by Vanangamudiyar (BalajiSaktivel) for being controlled by Nandini. PeriyaPazhuvettarayar falls in the cunningness of Nandini in each and every moment of he loses his mind. He also says that his eyes can only see her beauty and her beauty veils her intelligence. PeriyaPazhuvettarayar loved Nandini by protecting her from the questions regarding to her about controlling PeriyaPazhuvettarayar and about her influence on the Chola kingdom. PeriyaPazhuvettarayar warns his brother ChinnaPazhuvettarayar (RadhakrishnanParthiban) for suspecting Nandini in the case of signet ring. When it comes to the end of second part, PeriyaPazhuvettarayar gets kidnapped by the Pandiya assassins while trying to save the prince AdithaKarikalan (Vikram) from them and later he realizes that Nandini took advantage on his blind love towards her for killing the King SundaraChozhar (Prakash Raj), Prince AdithaKarikalan (Vikram) and Prince ArunmozhiVarman (Jayam Ravi) and to destroy the Chola

dynasty. The murder of AdithaKarikalan leads him to bend his head in front of the royal court because he also became a reason for the death of AdithaKarikalan. Here it is obvious that the concept of femme fatale in Nandini leads to the downfall of PeryiaPazhuvettarayar who is one of the most reputed personalities in Chola kingdom.

Another important character associated with Nandini is AdithaKarikalan who had a huge influence on the life of Nandini. AdithaKarikalan and Nandini were in love during their childhood but the royal family was against this relationship by pointing out that Nandini was an orphan. This leads to the deportation of Nandini from Chola kingdom and this changed the character of AdithaKarikalan too. Later during the battle of Seyvur which was fought between the kingdoms of Chola and Pandya, AdithaKarikalan meets Nandini again with deadly wounded VeeraPandiyan (the king of Pandya kingdom) at a hut. Nandini begs to AdithaKarikalan for VeeraPandiyan's life because VeeraPandiyan provided shelter for Nandini when she was deported from Chola kingdom. But for the sake of Chola kingdom AdithaKarikalan beheaded VeeraPandiyan in front of Nandini (AdithaKarikalan is also known as VeeraPandiyanThalaikondaAdithaKarikalan). This incident paved way to the vengeance of Nandini and Pandya assassins towards the Chola dynasty (The rise of femme fatale in Nandini). Later Nandini married PeriyaPazhuvettarayar to reach Chola kingdom again and to help Pandiya assassins from inside the royal palace to kill the king and princes. Due to these incidents AdithaKarikalan left to Kanchi from Tanjore (Thanjavur) and stayed with his army. After knowing about the chieftains' meeting for the coronation of MaduranthakaThevar (Rahman) as the next king of Chola Kingdom under the leadership of PeriyaPazhuvettarayar which was against the wish of King

SundaraChozhar, Malaiyaman warns AdithaKarikalan to move back to Tanjore to protect the King and reminds AdithaKarikalan that he should be the next king. During that conversation Malaiyaman talks that Nandini is a poisonous snake and now she is controlling PeriyaPazhuvettarayar. Malaiyaman's words provoked AdithaKarikalan and he shouted against Malaiyaman but AdithaKarikalan was well aware of Nandini's plot and her vengeance against Chola Kingdom. In the second part, the loyal friend of AdithaKarikalan ParthibendraPallavan (VikramPrabhu) falls in the beauty and words of Nandini and invites AdithaKarikalan to Kadambur for a peace treaty between the chieftains. In the conversation between AdithaKarikalan and ParthibendraPallavan, AdithaKarikalan realizes the changes happened to ParthibendraPallavan after meeting Nandini. AdithaKarikalan asks him that the snake (Nandini) seduced him too and AdithaKarikalan repeats about what she had said to him. Later AdithaKarikalan got murdered at Kadambur and this created a huge misunderstanding in ParthibendraPallavan. He believed that AdithaKarikalan was killed by Vallavaraiyan Vanthiyathevan for Arunmozhivarman's coronation. Later he joined with Rashtrakuta king Khottiga to kill Arunmozhivarman for taking revenge for his friend AdithaKarikalan's death. In that battle Chola army defeated Rashtrakutas and killed king Khottiga and ParthibendraPallavan.

Similar to the fangs of snakes Nandini also have some poisonous weapons; those are her beauty and cunningness. Her fangs are not just to seduce men, she can control and command on them. During the conspiracy of Pandiya assassins, Ravidasan presents a plot about how to kill the Chola king and princes. But Nandini intervenes and explains the faults of the plot presented by Ravidasan. Then she presents her plot to kill the king and princes at same

time because if they kill any one of them, they cannot even stay there. The protection of other two must be increased and the Pandiya assassins must be attacked by the Chola army. Finally the Pandiya assassins accept her plot to kill Chola king and princes. Another two important features of Nandini's character are her confidence and her fearless attitude. When Vallavaraiyan Vanthiyathevan sees tears on Nandini's eyes, she says that the Vanthiyathevan is the first man who saw her crying.

The filmmakers also created the situations to show the downfall of femme fatale. The first situation is the death of Aditha Karikalan. Nandini invites Aditha Karikalan to Kadambur for creating a peace treaty between the chieftains and him but her plot was to kill Aditha Karikalan by her own hands. But the conversation between Nandini and Aditha Karikalan leads to expose the hidden love of Nandini towards Aditha Karikalan. In the beginning of this conversation, Aditha Karikalan asks Nandini to apologize him for killing Veera Pandiyan. Later Aditha Karikalan reveals to Nandini that he knows her conspiracy with Pandiya assassins and her plot to kill him at Kadambur. Even though Aditha Karikalan invites her to his life by opposing all the restrictions but she rejects his invitation by lying on him that she wished to be on the throne that is why she married Periya Pazhuvettarayar and tried to save Veera Pandiyan. But she could not hide her love in front of Aditha Karikalan's mad towards her. Finally he gives his dagger to Nandini and forces her to kill him to wash out all the problems with his death but Nandini struggles to do that. But for sacrificing his life, Aditha Karikalan hugs Nandini by pointing the dagger towards him. At that time Nandini fails to hide her love and screams loudly for Aditha Karikalan by losing her vengeance.

After the death of Aditha Karikalan, the boatman

Karuthiruman (YogJapee) and the Pandiya assassinator Ravidasan (Kishore) reveal the truth about why the Pandiya assassins obeyed her words. The truth was the Pandiya king Veera Pandiyan raped Nandini's mother Mandakini (Aishwarya Rai Bachchan) and Mandakini gave birth to a child; her name is Nandini. She realizes the truth that she killed Aditha Karikalan for the one who molested her mother and she was a mere puppet in their hands. At last she realizes the blind love of Periya Pazhuvettarayar towards her was real. The guilty of betraying and destroying the reputation of Periya Pazhuvettarayar leads her to take the decision of sacrifice her life. Through these two scenes the director presents the downfall of femme fatale and also shows the poetic justice.

In conclusion, we can admit that the director Mani Ratnam scripted well the rise and fall of the concept of femme fatale throughout the two films. The male characters passed through the life of Nandini were tasted their death or their downfalls. The characters like Periya Pazhuvettarayar, Aditha Karikalan and Parthibendra Pallavan are few of them. Both films gave enough importance to their female characters including Kundavai (Trisha Krishnan), Oomai Rani/Mandakini (Aishwarya Rai Bachchan), Poonkuzhali (Aishwarya Lekshmi), Vanathi (Sobhita Dhulipala) Sembiyan Mahadevi (Jayachitra), Vasuki (Vinodhini Vaidyanathan), Rakkamma (Nimmy Raphael), Kani (Shakti Ramani), Vaanavan Mahadevi (Vidhya Subramanian) etc. The characters like Kundavai, Poonkuzhali, and Oomai Rani/Mandakini can be considered as the strong female leads tried to protect Chola dynasty from the Pandiya assassins. On the other hand, we can see Rakkamma, Vasuki, and Kani; they were on the side of Pandiya assassins and in these female characters, Kani sacrificed her life for helping Pandiya assassins with her on

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dagger. In short, it is evident that the films PonniyinSelvan part 1 and PonniyinSelvan part 2 were not a film which has been touched by the hands of phallocentrism. These two films give equal importance to both male and female characters and these characters were widely accepted by the audience. This leads to the worldwide success of these two films.

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10. DALIT LITERATURE

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Introduction:

‘Dalit’ is a term that has been embraced by individuals of untouchable group of India to depict and distinguish them. “Dalit” envelops the defenseless portion of the Indian society, which lives at the limit of the town, just as Adivasis, landless homestead workers, laborers, the enduring masses, and migrant and criminal clans and ladies. It isn’t just material to the untouchables yet to all who are falling behind socially and monetarily in the nation’s formative procedure. The term ‘Dalit’ is taken diversely by various researchers. The conversation in regard to who might be recognized as a Dalit writer will be continuous practice of fictional examination. Is a Dalit author a composer who holds a location with the Dalit people classification or any person who illustrates on the natural life of Dalits. The class Hindu writers, who have discussion to Dalits, have been resolutely faulted by the Dalit authors for trifle of their happenstances and comforts in opposition with Dalit.

Dalit literature is a genre of Indian writing that focuses on the lives, experiences, and strugglers of the Dalit community, who have faced caste-based oppression and discrimination for centuries. The first and most ancient Dalit literature” Madara Chennaiah”, written in the 18th century by a Cobbler who lived in Western Chalukya’s reign. The cobbler

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its to as often referred the “Father of vachana poetry” Dalit literature artistically portrays the sorrows, slavery, tribulations, degradation, poverty and ridicule endured by the Dalits of Indian society.

The first Dalit :

K. R. Narayanan was elected as the Vice- president of India in 1992 and later went on to become the President of India in 1997 He was the first person from the Dalit community to hold either post.

Cause for Dalit movement:

The division of labour led to their inequality and exploitation. The caste system degenerated Dalit life into pathogenic condition where occupations changed into castes. For centuries, were excluded from the mainstream society and allowed to pursue menial occupations.

Origin of Dalit Literature:

The social revolutionary struggle became the origin of Dalit literature. In the twentieth century after the colonialism, when there was an era of post-modernism, a democratic movement ascended that wanted a fair society where humans would be on the same ground irrespective of their caste, color and nations. The demand for equality and human rights induced the marginalized, depressed and aboriginal section of the society. India wasn't behind and humanism touched the society as well. Social reform movements gained pace against the conservative and stigmatized social mindset and culture. The revolution was a challenge to the caste system, which is the main culprit behind the social oppression and injustice to the Dalit people for ages. Mahatma Jyotiba Phule and Dr B.R. Ambedkar were the leaders who raised their voice against oppression and discrimination. To voice

their opinions, Dalit literature became a prolific medium. Primarily Marathi language was the medium for Dalit literature, later several other dialects like Gujarati became prominent after the 1960s. During the 1980s it became quite eminent after the anti-reservation movement in Gujarat. Presently, Gujarati Dalit literature has become a solid genre.

Dalit Movements in INDIA:

The earliest known Dalit reformer was Lord Gautam Budha, who preached the abolishing of untouchability. The earliest known reformation within Hinduism happened during the medieval period, when the Bhakti movements actively engaged in the participation and inclusion of dalits. In the 19th century, the Brahmo samaj, Arya samaj and the Ramakrishna mission actively participated in the emancipation of Dalits. Saint Kabir, Mahanubhava sect, Varkari sect in Maharashtra rejected the term untouchability and embraced Dalits as brothers.

Maharashtra state was the key state in the re formation of Dalit or on the transformation of untouchable to touchable. Mahatma Jyotiba Phule, Rajashri Shahu Maharaj, V. R. Shinde and the pinnacle towering figure Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar were the prominent social reformers in Maharashtra. In the 1950, Ambedkar turned his attention to Buddhism and converted thousands of untouchable people in Buddhism with himself. In west Bengal Chaitanya Prabhu initiated a movement called 'Namo shudras movement' (bow to Dalit) which changed an attitude towards untouchable community. Overall, Dalit reform movements had been in India since ancient period right from Gautama Buddha. Still it is in course of reforming state by creative efforts of social reformers.

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The great impact on Dalit Literature:

Dr. Ambedkar the everlasting inspiration for Dalit literature. The western educated champion of human rights doctor B.R. Ambedkar having bound knowledge about marginalized sections of India, have fought for the liberation of dalits from the clutches of casteist philosophy. Ambedkar, will remain the ultimate source of inspiration for Dalit literature. His thoughts contained people at graph of the progress of the grass roots of the society, which has become revolution. This revolution had changed the consciousness of the Dalits .

Dr. Ambedkar said “I like the religion that teaches liberty, equality and Fraternity”. He is universally accepted as the Father the Famous Dalit Consciousness Book written by Ambedkar: Annihilation of Caste.

This book is one of the most important, works of political writing from India. Written in 1936, it is an audacious denunciation of Hinduism and its caste system. Ambedkar argues that caste had no scientific basis.

“Dalit consciousness for Dalit literature is an important seed for Dalit literature.”

Vastness of Dalit literature:

- The main motto of the Dalit movement was Education , Association and Agitation.
- Dalit literature originally emerged in the Marathi language.
- The famous Dalit writer - Omprakash Valmiki.
- The first Dalit priest - Yedhu Krishnan.
- The first Dalit autobiography – Baluta.

11. POST COLONIAL LITERATURE

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The term post-colonial means post or after the colonial period. It is the antithesis of European literatures. Religion, education, politics are the colonizing tools. Post colonial literature is the literature that expresses opposition or resistance to colonization. It is written from the perspective of the former colonized. Post colonial literature attempts to describe indigenous people, places and practices to counteract the stereotypical images portrayed by the colonizers.

Though postcolonial literature is not exclusively written in English, postcolonial literature in English enjoys more fame and attention, partially because of the dominance of English on the global stage. The twentieth century was marked by anti-colonial rebellions and resistance movements from colonies all over the world. We can identify several contributing factors that inspired the rise of postcolonial literature:

- The introduction of English education made the native communities proficient in English, enough to be able to read, write, and speak English.
- Pro-independence movements against colonial authorities inspired the colonized subjects to write fictional and non-fictional accounts of life under colonial rule, sometimes as a part of the anti-colonial resistance.

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- Globalization and the free flow of commodities across nations gave an incentive for postcolonial writers to seek global fame for their creative efforts in English.
- Writers of postcolonial backgrounds broke away from their regional and indigenous modes of storytelling by adopting the language and narrative modes of the west. This is seen simultaneously as a consequence of cultural disruption as well as an act of co-opting the language of the colonial authority to express native sentiments and stories.

Two thousand seasons is a 1973 novel, published by African author Ayi Kwei Armah. It depicts the last two thousand seasons in African history through one narrative storyline. It focuses on themes of slavery, the complicities of African leaders, the continued oppression of African culture, and more. The novel has been subject to mixed reviews; including a 1987 review by Chinua Achebe in which he described the book as “unacceptable on the basis of fact, and on the basis of art.” Post colonial literature speaks on themes of colonialism, nationalism, cultural identity, family, the future and the past, and more. Postcolonial writers often utilize the language of their colonizers effort to speak plainly and clearly about the effects that colonialism has had on their country and culture. It should be acknowledged, however, that whatever the developments were, that led to the formation of the field of postcolonial studies, it has to be seen more in terms of a long process rather than a series of events, with the central impulses of this process coming from a variety of sources, sometimes outside any concern with colonialism. These may be traced in a variety of directions, such as in the changing face of global politics with the emergence of newly independent states; in the wide-ranging re-evaluation begun in the 1980s of the exclusionary forms of western reason and in the perception of their complicity with imperial expansion and colonialist rule; in the debates

that raged about empiricism and cultureless in the social sciences from the 1960s; and in the challenges to dominant discourses of representation from feminist, gay, lesbian and ethnic studies in the 1970s and 1980s. Postcolonial writers have this thing they like to do. They take the language of their colonizer (English or French) and turn it on its head. A writer from the Caribbean, for example, may write a novel or play in English around, write in dialect, make the language sound spoken instead of written, pepper it with native phrases and terms. It's still English, but it's a different kind of English.

Colonizers liked to tell a story. In the story, Europeans were created to rule over other, lesser people, from the Irish to the Igbo. Europeans were the designated masters, the rulers of the earth. Therefore they were justified in ruling over others: that was their destiny. And anyway, they weren't really in it for their own profit. They were enlightening the darker peoples, you see. They were civilizing them. Postcolonial writers have a big problem with this story. After all, from their perspective, colonization wasn't about brutal economic exploitation. And what really bothers them is that this story was told, and repeated by the colonizers, as though it were a fact. Europeans wanted everyone -including their colonized subjects -to accept it as true.

So postcolonial writers started pointing out that, actually, there's more than one side to the story. In fact, there are often loads of different sides to the same story. A story that we take to be "true" or "factual" is often just one point of view among many. So is often just one point of view among many. So in their own work, postcolonial writers tend to play around with.

Indian society in the colonial period was very rigid and was beset with social evils like the sati, widow-remarriage, the caste system and the social, religious as well as kinds

of hegemony. The primary aim of the writers of this period is in most of the consequences of these evils and also to bring awareness among them. For instance, in Malayalam, O. Chandumenon in his work *Indhulekha* (1889) takes "issue with the colonial characterization of Nair society and especially of Nair women. In postcolonial writing a greater emphasis was put on the process of colonialization and attempt was made to record a strong resistance to the masters of the colonized societies besides insisting on contemporary realities of life. It deals with the literature written in colonized countries about the sufferings of the masses and also about the resistance of the people who were at the receiving end. Postcolonial writings can be considered as the historical marker of the period because it deals the literature which comes after decolonization. Postcolonial writers engaged themselves in opening up the possibilities of a new language and a new way of looking towards the world. Their writings can be taken as a medium of resistance to the former colonizer. Their themes focus on the issues like identity, national and cultural heritage, hybridity, partition, contemporary reality, human relationships and emotions etc.

The rise of Indian English writing in postcolonial era was a significant development in Indian English literature. In the Indian context, postcolonial writing with its new themes and techniques makes its presence felt in the English-speaking world. Subaltern study is also a major sphere of current postcolonial practice. Gayatri Chakraborty Spivak, Kancha Iliah, Ranjit Guha and others have focused on the subaltern issues in their works. The literary works of the colonial nationalist period revolved around themes like marginalization, widowhood and widow remarriage. It was Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyaya, who for the first time, sought to bring the national movement and patriotism

in his novel *Anandmath* (1882). Later, it was followed by Rabindranath Tagore and others. The entire history of Indian English novel can broadly be divided into two periods: pre-independence novel and post-independence novel. The pre-independence period witnessed a slow growth of Indian English novel. It begins with the publications of Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyaya, Rabindranath Tagore, Raja Rao wrote mainly under the influence of Gandhism and traditions, rites and rituals, poverty and illiteracy, bonds and bondages in their novels on the one hand and on the other, they made their writings a powerful medium to highlight the east-west encounter and thereby to spread the nationalistic ideas of the great leaders like Mahatma Gandhi among the people. Mulk Raj Anand, R.K. Narayan and Raja Rao presented the radical social and national issues in their novels. The novels produced in the pre-independence period depicted the changing socio-political scene.

Conclusion

The post-colonial period in India has resulted in shaping new identities and cultures that through studying and surveying the colonial period attempt to re-explore their marginalized identities and cultures and to constitute a modern society by creating new mental and analytical structures based on the Indian culture. Indeed, the Indian writers have challenged even the post-colonial definitions and parameters, and although in the majority of the Britain's colonies the English language has been the language of the literature of the post-colonial stage, the Indian writers have developed their indigenous languages along with it. Emergence of the post-colonial literature in India is the authentic representation of these attempts and developments.

One of the most exciting features of English literature today is the explosion of postcolonial literatures written in English

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in former colonized societies. This has given rise to a range of theoretical ideas, concept, problems and debates, and these have been addressed in a range of articles, essays, talks and books. Here attempt is made on to look at the post-colonial studies Indian literature. It was a period which witnessed many changes in Indian society. The impact of western education and industrial developments were led to radical changes in society. The social reformists like Raja Ram Mohan Roy, Dayanand Saraswati, K. C. Sen, Ishwar Chandra, Jyotiba phule have tried to give a new life to the decadent contemporary society and thought about the social problems of the society through their writings. The intellectuals of this period started spreading the message of progressive and rational ideas.

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12. GENDER INEQUALITY IN THE PLAY DANCE LIKE A MAN

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Abstract

Dance like a Man is a powerful drama of post-independence society, involving the aspirations of a middle class South Indian couple, who by their choice of profession as a Bharatanatyam dancer reflect the past and the present Indian culture, problems of identity and gender roles. The theme of the play is dealt with tradition, relationship, career, and society.

The play 'Dance like a Man' strikes hard at the society that prescribes certain roles to each gender and treats them as idiotic. Jairaj, the male protagonist of the play becomes a victim of gender restrictions. Usually women become victims or suffer due to the patriarchal culture. But this play focuses on the plight of a male who tries to break the conventional roles allotted to his gender by the society. In this process, he loses his identity as an artist in society.

Key Words: Gender, Patriarchal, identity.

Research Paper:

Dance like a Man is a play by Mahesh Dattani, which deals with the dogma of being a man in the 1940s, of the Indian society. Although the story revolves around a dancer couple and their family, but the emotions of the play lies in the emotional and social dance. Jairaj did dance to the tune of

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his father, his dancer and intelligent wife and to the tune of this society.

This play deals with the recent, and ancient, history of India in personal terms, probing three generations of conflict against a background that evokes the highest achievements of ancient Sanskrit theatre and classical religious dance. Some of the turns in this story are harrowing, and the bitterness of the characters can be deeply unsettling. The play deals with the conflict between art and society. It also focuses on the sense of competition among the artists themselves. Young Jairaj and Ratna are practicing dance in the house of Amritlal Parekh. He is representative of the society of the nineteen thirties and forties. He is a freedom fighter and a reformist, but limits the freedom of his son. His son, Jairaj wants to become a male Bhartanatyam dancer. Amritlal Parekh is an autocratic father for him. Bhartanatyam is the “craft of prostitute to show off her wares”. Hence a man has no business to learn such an art, and anyone who “learnt such a craft would not be a man”. But Amritlal never thought the interest of his son in dance “would turn into an obsession”. According to Jairaj, Amritlal Parekh was “a conservative and prudish” as the white rulers.

In the earlier days Bhartanatyam was associated with temples and rituals. The art was preserved by Devadasis. They were the professional dancers in temples. They were exploited by the priests and rulers. Finally, due to the economic needs this turned to prostitution. So, the dance form was ignored and neglected till nineteen thirties and forties. It further led the society to oppose this dance form. The artist’s societal condition compels them to accept this vocation. But the individual space they want must not be denied by so called civilization. And such gender discrimination regarding the dance form is the hyper discrimination in the world of artists. So no man wants to learn this dance form. If anyone

wants to learn such a dance he ceases to be man.

Bharatanatyam when practiced by a male is considered to render him effeminate. Though the divine exponent of Bharatanatyam is none other than Lord Shiva himself, this art form is associated with women by a misconception. Jairaj's passion of Bharatanatyam goes unappreciated by his own father. His dancing is a way of expressing his own identity. He is a man who defies social norms. But his life is defeated by his father and his wife. "If the play questions conventional male stereotypes and points out that male identity is a construction conditioned by social norms and expectations, it does so by involving those very same constructions for the female characters" says Angelie Multani in her paper, "On Mahesh Dattani's Dance like a Man: The politics of production and Performance."

Jairaj and Ratna might have succeeded as dancers but they have failed as human beings and as wife and husband. The play ends with Jairaj's admission that they were only humans and lacked the 'grace', 'brilliance' and magic to dance like God.

In order to protect and continue any art form, the artist should raise above human weakness. It is a state of human consciousness that wraps up the distinction of male and female into a state of 'wholeness'. In his self-discovery, Jairaj discovers that the divine essence of human self is neither male nor female.

An Invisible Coat over the Society:

Gender inequality is a form of discrimination which is especially found in Indian culture and also in certain other cultures. Gender is often called as the 'social construct' which means that the inequality between man and woman on the floor of gender is the result of the social authoritative principle set in from the ancient period, while Sex is a

considered to be called as the 'biological construct'. The voice and protest against the rights of a woman have become powerful in the present period but unfortunately the man has been given priority in this aspect and is always considered as 'a citizen of a privileged class'. In India, it is an assumption that only women have been suppressed of their desires, dominated by the power of others and are the victims of the gender discrimination but that is not the fact, as men also have to face the bigotry. Men like women are also the sufferer of the society as men are judged on masculinity floor and gallant qualities.

This study explores the inner self of the protagonist, Jairaj in Mahesh Dattani's 'Dance Like a Man'. The play 'Dance like a Man' strikes hard at the society that prescribes certain roles to each gender and treats them as idiotic. Jairaj, the male protagonist of the play becomes a victim of gender restrictions. Usually women become victims or suffer due to the patriarchal culture. But this play focuses on the plight of a male who tries to break the conventional roles allotted to his gender by the society. In this process, he loses his identity as an artist in society. Jairaj's dreams are shattered as his father considers that Bhartanatyam is an effeminate thing that belongs to female gender. A man practicing the dance is entirely unacceptable for the people of the society. His father, being a spokesperson of the society fears that his son would lose his identity as a male. Jairaj cannot accept that he has lost his individuality as an artist, but he comprehends his own self at the end of the play and his self-discovery brings a revelation of the essence of the art which has nothing to do with the practitioner being either male or female.

Dance like a Man is a play that deals with the issues of Gender. Dattani brings out this issue from one of his principal passions, Dance. This play talks about a young

man who wants to be a dancer. He is growing up in a world that believes dance is for a woman. Dance, particularly Bhartanatyam is a very beautiful art form. It is practiced by committed exponents for spiritual activity. But, the middle class Indian society does not approve of a man being a practitioner of this art form because it is considered to render him effeminate. A Man must act like a man. Being the provider of the family, he can indulge in manly sports that give identity to his sex.

Dance like a Man explores the life of a budding dancer, Jairaj. It also explores how he loses his career, his passion, his dreams and his purposes in life to societal notions of gender. Jairaj and his wife Ratna are dancers. They are under the shelter of Jairaj's father Amritlal Parekh. It is mentioned in the text that Ratna chose Jairaj as her life partner so that her career would not be compromised. But Amritlal Parekh is a man of fixed notions. So he is unable to tolerate his son wanting to become a professional dancer. Bhartanatyam is good as a hobby, but to be taken up as a profession by a man is something unthinkable.

The focus of the play is how social conventions and traditions of gender spoil the life of the both male and female. The dramatic structure of the play evolves round the idea that individuals struggle against the society. The issue of gender discrimination is associated with individual choices, self development and self identity.

Conclusion: Individual is as much a part of his own inner conscience, as much as he is a part of defined social code. The perpetual clash of human motives with the tradition of family, prejudice of society and the code of culture.

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13. QUEER STUDIES: AN ASSERTION OF SEXUALITY AND GENDER IDENTITY OF A TRANSGENDER

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Introduction

The specific nature or content of any gender order is constantly in process, being formed and changed. It is fashioned by actions of individuals who are themselves formed in that interaction. It is created in the struggles and power strategies and contradictions and unintended consequences of a multitude of social groups and individuals and interests.

The present paper aims at explaining the concepts of sexuality and gender identities by enquiring about the selected narrative of an Indian writer. In certain writings, many writers drew the attention of academicians through their life narratives. Such writings deserve an academic investigation from different points of view. The research paper intends not only to focus on the concepts of sexualities and gender identities but also to identify social and cultural issues of transgender through this writing. The narrative, which has been written from different points of view, purposes, styles, and narrative strategies, will be investigated. The present paper is an attempt to understand how does the

writer reveal the gender identities of transgenders? Why are they marginalised in a society, where taboos and gender stereotypes are culturally and socially constructed? In this respect, the investigation intends to analyse the concepts and context of sexuality and gender identities by writers. The study of the concept aims at reconstructing the interpretation of social and cultural milieus that have surrounded transgenders and the investigation of the context aims at finding out the taboos and gender stereotypes that marginalised the voice of transgenders.

The area of the present paper, broadly speaking, is the study of sexualities and gender identities as a part of queer studies. Though the concepts of gender and sexual identities have their genesis in gender studies, it falls under Queer studies, which forms a backdrop to the present study.

Gender Identity and Sexuality

Gender, term is referred to as the state of being male or female. The gender order is a patterned system of ideological and material practices; performed by individuals in a society, through which power relations between women and men are made and remade, as meaningful. The concept of gender is valuable for the analysis of gender, particularly for understanding the relationship between individual gendered subjectivities and gender as a social structure. The gender order provides the mode of interpretation through which individuals construct an embodied subjective and social identity. (B L Marshal 1994). Gender is all around us. Beliefs about gender impact our jobs, families, schools, religions, laws, politics, relationships, sports, clothes, and so much more. Gender permeates almost every aspect of our lives as humans. (Laura, Schroth and Davis,2021).

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Gender identity is complex and varies with cultural context. Our gender identities are shaped by the fact that we grow up in different homes and families, with distinct traditions and gendered role models. Man and woman are the words we use to identify a complex array of gendered thoughts, ideals, and assumptions. (Laura, Schroth and Davis, 2021). Gender identity forms early on as part of a developmental process of identity formation wherein young person begins to understand themselves and their place in their world.

Gender roles reflect societal expectations for behaviours based on gender. A person's gender expression involves their mode of demonstrating gender to the world, through clothing, hairstyle, and mannerisms. Sexual orientation is separate from gender identity and reflects the genders or sexes of the people someone is attracted to. (Laura, Schroth and Davis, 2021) Gender roles, the positions and responsibilities expected of us, based on our assigned gender- vary from country to country and even within countries depending on our social groups. However, there is a controversy over the relative contributions of “nature” and “nurture” to our gender identity –our internal sense of our gender. While gender roles and gender expression may depend heavily on social influences, there is building evidence that gender identity may have biological components, such as genetic or hormonal influences. Gender identity is our self-conception of who we are - our innermost sense of being a man, a woman, or something else entirely. (Laura, Schroth and Davis, 2021).

Gender expression may also change over a person's lifespan. Young people often present in hyper feminine or hypermasculine ways, and their gender expression often becomes

less stereotypical as they come to understand themselves and their own identities better. Masculinity is often seen as corresponding with confidence, which is signalled through eye contact, bold body language, and a loud voice commandeering attention. Femininity is signalled through a person's tendency to emote, accessorize, be more delicate in their mannerisms and dress, show more of their body through their clothing, wear makeup, and engage in less competitive, more nurturing activities. An outward expression can be significantly different depending on the cultural context. (Laura, Schroth and Davis, 2021).

Gender expression is a complex series of actions that serve to prompt those around us to better understand who we are inside. However, the strength of cultural norms dictating what expressive qualities and characteristics are appropriate to indicate masculinity and femininity have reinforced a narrow and binary range of acceptable behaviours for men and women, respectively. (Laura, Schroth and Davis, p.6).

In simple terms, sometimes, something is 'gendered' when its character is either masculine or feminine; or when it exhibits patterns of difference by gender. Using gender as a verb is a reflection of changed understandings of gender as an active ongoing process, rather than something ready-made and fixed. In this sense, then something is gendered, When it is, in and of itself, actively engaged in social processes that produce and reproduce distinctions between women and men (Pilcher and Whelehan, 2017)

As gender identity refers to the inner sense most of us have of being either male or female. It has its origins in psychiatry: It is most commonly used to refer to transsexual and transgender individuals, who are those most at risk for feeling some discordance between their bodies and that inner sense (Riki Wilchins,2004). Each community expects women and men to think, feel, and act in certain ways,

simply because they are women or men. Community norms, whether implicit or explicit, shape gender roles, and these expectations are often deeply woven into the fabric of daily life (Laura, Schroth and Davis, 2021). Despite most recent research about gender identity being “biological” there is evidence that there may also be social and environmental influences on gender identity. If we take a broad perspective, looking around we see that most societies have predefined roles for men and women and that most people stick to these relative boundaries, coming to understand themselves as the genders they were assigned at birth (Laura, Schroth and Davis, 2021).

Gender nonconformity refers to the experience of someone who does not identify or express the culturally accepted set of gendered behaviours or actions associated with the sex they were assigned at birth. There is a range of gender-nonconforming behaviours. Gender nonconformity might describe a masculine woman or a feminine man, or someone whose gender identity is different from that which they were assigned at birth. A gender-nonconforming behaviour means that the way someone is perceived transgresses the assumptions of how a man or woman should function in a certain setting. (Laura, Schroth and Davis, 2021). If gender identity refers to someone’s inner sense of their gender whereas, sexuality, on the other hand, involves a person’s attractions. For example, a transgender woman assigned male at birth may identify as a woman (her gender identity) and may be attracted to any combination of people. She may label her sexuality as gay, straight, bisexual, queer, or something else. (Laura, Schroth and Davis, 2021). Nor will sexual orientation alone usually make a person a complete outsider, and therefore innocent of all patriarchal or exploitative taint. A gay person may be a comfortably tenured academic, very much a privileged insider in the

eyes of, say, a factory worker, gay or not, in a small town. (Peter Barry, p140)

The term transgender refers to someone who identifies with a gender that is outside the expectations associated with the sex they were assigned at birth. Being transgender is separate from identifying as gay, lesbian, or queer and should not be confused with sexuality or sexual orientation. Transgender is not an “extreme version “of being gay. Many transgender people partner with those of a different gender and identify as heterosexual. Some people believe that being transgender is a choice, but most experts in the field believe that the only choice is how and if to disclose the identity, not whether or not it exists. The decision to disclose, or “come out,” as transgender varies from person to person. (Laura, Schroth and Davis,2021)

Some transgender individuals describe their childhood very differently. They may say that they were less concerned with gender identity growing up; however, they had a strong sense of not fitting in or that something internal was either miscalibrated or mistuned. (Laura, Schroth and Davis p.15)

Transgender identities can be nuanced and sometimes seen as contradictory to the observer. Traditionally, we associate a male sex assignment with an identity of a boy or man and a masculine expression. Similarly, a baby identified as female at birth is normed to identify as a girl and then a woman, presenting feminine attributes and characteristics. “Born in the wrong body” (Laura, Schroth and Davis,2021)

Post puberty, a transgender person usually has to make an intentional decision about disclosing their transgender identity to their community. Depending on their presenting gender expression, the disclosure may confirm theories or suspicion or may come as an incredible shock. The experience of coming out often marks a stressful time in a transgender person’s life. On one hand, this might be

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the time when an individual first shares their truest self. However, there is often a concern for ostracization, blame, shame, or disownment. (Laura, Schroth and Davis, 2021). It is against such a background that the present paper tries to explain, analyse and conceptualize the phenomenon's of sexuality and gender identity written by an Indian writer and activist of the queer movement.

The Truth About Me: A Hijra Life Story – As an Assertion of Gender Identity and Sexuality

The writer, A.Revathi, a transwoman, is a Bangalore-based activist who is giving her voice to sex workers or sexual minorities in south India. The Truth About Me: A Hijra Life Story is her second book which was published in 2010. This is her autobiography (originally written by her in Tamil as Unarvum Uruvamu and translated into English as The Truth About Me: A Hijra Life Story by V. Geetha) in which she discusses the hidden issues of transgender and how much difficulty they faced to survive in the Indian community. She belongs to the hijra community, considered a set-aside community. In this book, she narrates her personal life events and reveals her personal experiences which she faced, being a third gender. This novel reflects the mental agony and sufferings of every transgender. She is also the first transgender writer who explores and informs the tragic and untold issues of heteronormative people in society through this autobiographical story. The novel highlights how the people of the third gender are marginalised in the colonial setup and what are the hurdles they faced including harassment during the establishment of their identity. Transgender identity issues are ignored as they could not find the proper identity in their society.

The writer Revathi describes not only her social background in her hometown but also her dreams and desires in her

writing. Revathi was born and brought up by her parents in the name of Doraiswamy with feminine qualities. While studying the seventh standard, he sensed certain biological changes in his body and mind. And then, he was surprised and fascinated by his gender identity. He showed interest without any hesitation to become a woman. In the beginning, Doraiswamy secretly maintains his gender issue from his parents for some time. Finally, during the temple festival, Doraiswamy declared himself a female Revathi. One of the most important things in the identical issue is accepting things. Wearing the woman costume for disguising himself as a woman cannot be considered transgender. But society has to accept it as a woman.

The novel is an exploration of gender identity as well as the sexuality of transgenders in general and Revathi in particular. It is not only about a single character. But it was an untold miserable story of every transgender in the social order. She tries to explain the hardship of transgender life and elaborated on the cultural norms followed by hijras and how the guru-chela relationship was prevailing all over India. The prime concept of the identical crisis is to prove and figure out gender and sexual norms. "The question of the identical crisis plays an important role in queer studies since indemnity is bound with mutually dependent and undefined social construction," That is why, many questions raise in Doraiswamy's mind like why do I love men? Am I mad? Why should I have felt like this? Is there any person in the world with the same feeling? and so on. Doraiswamy wanted to be a woman as he felt women inside. The queer theory specifies that people who belong to sexual minorities are not able to fit into the social norms. Her writing highlighted some of her prime issues and advocated for changing the prejudice which was prevailing against transgender people in their sociocultural atmosphere.

In Indian society, the hijras, the eunuchs, and the transgender community were allowed to enjoy their share and rights. That is why; Revathi was valorously leading towards her autobiography to break the stereotypical law against the transgender community and heteronormative people. It is evident from the lines of her writing that she tries to explore her gender identity and sexuality by detailing the following lines, Doraisamy, being born with the body of a male was expected to behave like a male by the heteronormative society. But Doraisamy's male body nurtured the desires and passions of being a female. He always felt that a woman is trapped within a man's body:

"A woman trapped in a man's body was how I thought of myself. I wondered why God had chosen to inflict this peculiar torture on me, and why He could not have created me wholly male or wholly female. Why am I a flawed being, I wondered often and all the time I was obsessed, confused and anxious" (p15)

Revathi in the autobiography narrates multiple incidences to show how passionately Doraisamy wanted to dress like a woman and how he enjoyed playing the role of female characters on stage during the school's annual day celebration or how he enjoyed putting on the "Female disguise" during the celebration of the Mariamman festival in their village:

"As soon as I got home from school, I would wear my sister's long skirt and blouse, twist a long towel around my head and let it trail down my back like a braid. I would then walk as if I was a shy bride, my eyes on the ground. "In class, I would sit staring at the girls, taking note of the way their braids fell, an intricate knot of their colourful ribbons, the jasmine and Kanakambaram they wore in their hair, and their skirts and blouses. I longed to be like them and suffered that I could not dress so. I played Chandramathi in Harishchandra. I think I did this exceptionally well because

everyone praised me saying that I looked and acted like a real woman. This pleased me very much.” “In my kurathi’s garb, I could express all those female feelings that I usually have to suppress and so felt happy. I had not worn a disguise I said to myself; I had given form to my real feelings.” (p14-16).

Revathi who through her autobiography, for the first time, bravely attempts to challenge and break this cyclic process of gender colonization and heteronormative discourse. To narrate the everyday life of a hijra was not so easy, it was not so easy to re-live all those moments of agony and brutal torture, but Revathi took the trouble to do so only with the hope that after the publication of this autobiography, a hijra is no longer “stared at” and “laughed” but rather considered as a human being:

“Men and even women stared at us, laughed, and heckled us. I realized what a burden a hijra’s daily life is. Do people harass those who are men and women when they go out with their families? Why, a crippled person, a blind person—even attracts pity and people help them. If someone has experienced physical hurt, they are cared for by family and outsiders who come to know of it. But we —we are not considered human.” (p83).

The autobiographical narration of the writer reveals that she tries to assert her own gender identity at the beginning of the story, notwithstanding all the barriers of heteronormative culture. She negotiated her identity with hijras and remains transgender. She desired to fulfill her sexuality as a female and asserted it by marrying a man.

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14. INFLUENCE OF DIGITAL MEDIA ON LANGUAGE AND CULTURE

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Abstract

Digitalization is a very common problem and also an advantage for all the people around the world. Spending a lot of time in front of the screen has changed the understanding of people, cultures and languages as it changes everything through the process. All the communication systems especially education is reconsidered through the needs of people. By the help of technology, people interact with different kinds of people facing different kinds of culture; but the lingua franca language English, has also become the language of digital culture, so all the languages are affected by this language as the globalization continues its effects through digital world. Yet the use of mother tongue languages and the cultures with the effect of digitalization have not been expired but transformed. In this article, the transformation process of both written and spoken versions of mother tongue languages into new inevitable digital language and the effects on cultures is examined by giving examples from the world languages and Turkish.

Introduction

Digitalization has brought human life into the process of irreversible change. Digital new technologies have changed the way people interact with each other, how experiences are shared and disseminated, and the way reality is presented and perceived. The reason why this process of change is irreversible is that as a result of children growing up with these new digital technologies, their lives and developments continue under the influence of these technologies. It is unthinkable that digitalization, which affects human beings from an early age, does not affect the languages that form the basis of human societies and cultures. These cultures are the sum of the values that societies have revealed in the historical-social evolution processes. In this article, the relationship between digitalization and language are focused on the relationship between digitalization and language on two different platforms is considered: One of them; is the data flow from a certain center such as printing, publishing, radio, and television, but in return, the other one is the response platform of individuals. At this platform, the addressee is mostly a community and this community is in a passive state. Therefore, both the individuals of this community and the language spoken by the community are affected by the information flow and the language in which the information flow is provided, at the individual and community level, and sometimes they are put under pressure. The second platform is a common information network where individuals can interact with each other or with the system, although it partially contains some of the features of the first. This reciprocity, of course, affects the relationship of the whole with the language differently.

Another dimension that should not be overlooked in the relationship between digitalization and language is the

relationship of digitalization with writing. Although the writing itself is not a part of the language directly, it is an element that should be taken into account because it is a means of visually conveying the sub-language.

One more situation that should be noted is, research shows that the use of common information networks is concentrated in North America and Europe, especially in the United States. These geographies are also the regions with the least linguistic diversity in the world. In addition, in Africa, the region with the highest linguistic diversity in the world, the common information network is almost non-existent (Week, 1990:143) For this reason, it would not be wrong to think that the dominance of the languages that currently dominate the common information network will be shaken in parallel with the spread of the common information network in the world and the digitalization of local languages.

Media Impact on Language

Language Evolution and Change: Digital media, particularly social media and online platforms, have accelerated the pace of language evolution and change. The constant interaction and communication on these platforms have led to the creation of new words, phrases, and even entire languages (e.g., internet slang, emojis, and memes). The brevity and speed of communication often require condensing and adapting language, leading to innovative linguistic expressions.

Globalization of Language: Digital media has facilitated the globalization of language. People from different linguistic backgrounds interact online, leading to the emergence of new hybrid languages and the spread of dominant languages like English. This phenomenon has both positive and negative effects on cultural diversity and preservation.

Cultural Exchange and Awareness: Digital media allows individuals from various cultures to share their traditions, customs, and practices, leading to increased cultural exchange and awareness. Users can access information about other cultures, leading to greater understanding and appreciation of diversity.

Cultural Homogenization: On the flip side, the pervasive influence of certain digital media platforms can lead to cultural homogenization, where some aspects of dominant cultures dominate and overshadow local cultures. This may result in the loss of traditional language and cultural practices.

Social Media Language and Identity: Digital media platforms have become arenas for the construction and performance of identity. Users often adopt specific language styles and linguistic markers to align with particular social groups or communities, reinforcing group identity and solidarity.

Miscommunication and Language Fragmentation: The nature of digital communication, such as texting and instant messaging, can lead to misunderstandings due to the lack of non-verbal cues and context. Additionally, language fragmentation can occur as different social media platforms which develop their own unique communication norms and linguistic styles.

Language Preservation and Revitalization: Digital media can be a powerful tool for language preservation and revitalization efforts. Indigenous communities, for example, can use online platforms to document, teach, and pass down their languages to younger generations.

Online Hate Speech and Polarization: Digital media has also been linked to the spread of hate speech and the polarization of societies. The relative anonymity online can embolden individuals to use offensive language, leading to

tensions between different cultural and social groups.

Influence on Language Learning: Digital media has revolutionized language learning. Language learning apps, online courses, and interactive platforms have made learning a new language more accessible and engaging.

The influence of digital media is pervasive and multifaceted, impacting various aspects of our lives. Here are some key areas where digital media has had a significant influence:

1. Communication and Connectivity: Digital media has revolutionized the way we communicate, enabling instant and global connectivity. Social media, messaging apps, emails, and video conferencing have made it easy to stay in touch with friends, family, and colleagues, regardless of distance.

2. Information Access and Dissemination: With digital media, accessing information has become more efficient and convenient. Online news portals, blogs, and websites provide real-time updates on a wide range of topics, empowering individuals to stay informed and engaged with current events.

3. Entertainment and Media Consumption: Digital media has transformed how we consume entertainment. Streaming services, online gaming, and user-generated content platforms have replaced traditional media channels, offering personalized and on-demand content.

4. E-Commerce and Online Shopping: Digital media has facilitated the rise of e-commerce, changing the way we shop. Online marketplaces and retail websites allow consumers to browse and purchase products from the comfort of their homes.

5. Education and Learning: Digital media has revolutionized education, making learning resources accessible to a global audience. Online courses, educational apps, and e-learning platforms provide opportunities for remote and self-paced

learning.

6. Influence on Consumer Behavior: Digital media plays a significant role in shaping consumer behavior. Social media influencers, online reviews, and targeted advertisements impact purchasing decisions and brand loyalty.

The culture and language of digital media have revolutionized the way we communicate, access information, and engage with the world. Social media platforms have become hubs of digital culture, fostering a participatory environment where user-generated content thrives. People can now share their ideas, experiences, and creativity with a global audience, leading to the democratization of information and media production. Emojis and emoticons have transcended language barriers, providing a universal means of expression that adds depth and nuances to online conversations. The use of hashtags has transformed content discovery, allowing users to connect over shared interests and follow trending topics in real-time.

Moreover, memes, with their sharp humor and cultural references, have become a language of their own, shaping online discourse and serving as vehicles for social commentary. Influencer culture has redefined marketing strategies, where individuals with substantial followings wield significant influence over consumer behavior and brand perception. The lexicon of digital media has expanded with online jargon and acronyms, fostering a sense of community among internet users and streamlining communication in the fast-paced online environment.

The culture and language of digital media encompass the distinctive characteristics of communication and interaction within the realm of digital technologies and online platforms. With the rise of social media and user-generated content, individuals now actively contribute and share their thoughts, images, and videos, shaping the digital

discourse. Emojis and emoticons have become integral to online conversations, conveying emotions and context in a visually engaging manner. Hashtags play a central role in organizing content and facilitating discussions around specific topics, while memes and viral content add humor and cultural references to the digital landscape. Influencer culture has emerged, with individuals amassing significant followings and influencing their audiences' behaviors and opinions. Online jargon and acronyms are commonplace, creating a unique language of digital communication.

Beyond entertainment and personal expression, digital media has also become a catalyst for activism and awareness. People can now mobilize online to rally support for causes, create powerful hashtag campaigns, and leverage the power of the internet to enact change on a global scale. Multilingualism plays a crucial role as digital media connects individuals from diverse linguistic backgrounds, making it essential for content creators to consider localization and translation to reach broader audiences.

In this interconnected digital landscape, personal branding has emerged as individuals curate their online personas to showcase specific aspects of their identity and expertise. However, the dynamic nature of digital media also poses challenges, such as the spread of misinformation and the potential for cyber bullying. Understanding and navigating this evolving culture and language of digital media are essential for individuals, businesses, and society as a whole to effectively communicate, collaborate, and engage in the digital age.

Conclusion

It is seen that digitalization and especially the common information network creates an intricate relationship with language. There are many opinions in Turkey and in

the world that digitalization in general and especially the common information network has some effects on individual languages. Moreover, it is witnessed that these effects are seen even on English, which is considered as the world wide language today. However, it seems that these effects are not interpreted in the same way by everyone.

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15. REVISITING THE HISTORY OF INDIA – A JOURNEY INTO THE WORLD OF HISTORICAL FICTIONS.

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ABSTRACT:

English literary works authored by Indian authors are included in Indo-Anglican Literature, commonly referred to as Indian English Literature. Indians were mostly raised by listening the Ramayana, Mahabharata, and Puranas. The urge to retell these stories have made our writers to pen down their viewpoints on the ancient history of India. Together, these books have given rise to the distinct literary genre known as historical fiction. The focus of the current study is on such works that interpret both the principles of the original work and certain combined concepts. The main focus of this article is how much these writings replicate the Indian epics and stories, which continue to have profound relevance even in the modernized world.

Introduction:

India has chronicled a magnificent past with its events like Puranas, Ramayana and Mahabharata. Probably many of the Indians have spent their childhood listening to these tales. Through this, the knowledge of philosophical truth, ethical standards, cultural norms, and moral ideals has been handed down from one generation to the next.

The Indian culture has astounded the entire globe. Since the contemporary world rejects the notion of tradition, culture and some practises, such as epics, have lost their importance

in current society. On the other hand, Indian youngsters are readily attracted towards western culture. Rather than adopting ourselves to western culture, we can look back to our own cultural heritage that we and our ancestors have come through. It never forgets to promulgate the scrupulous values that every human living on this earth should embrace in their lives.

But in recent years, these epics have witnessed its modernisation through historical fiction and also of late, epics have undergone changes and transformations with their handling of modernising the holy figures and the story. Despite the fact that the tales in all of these fictional works are identical, the authors' ability to freshen up the way these epics are handled is what sets them apart.

Writing historical fiction is a difficult endeavour. Recreating the events that happened long ago in the minds of readers through books is not everyone's cup of tea! However, many writers today have offered youngsters the opportunity to rediscover India's history through their own viewpoints.

Vedic Period and Prosthesis:

Saiswaroopaa Iyer, the author of 'Avishi – Warrior Queen from the Rig Veda' has reimagined the story of a courageous warrior Vishpala. She has been mentioned in the verses of Rigveda which invoke the deity, Ashwini Devatas – the heavenly doctors. The author was inspired to reimagine the figure of Vishpala and write a novel after discovering that she was mentioned in few verses of Rigveda.

Long before the times of Draupadi and Sita

Immortalized in the hymns of Rigveda

But forgotten to the memory of Indian

Was the warrior queen with an iron leg, Vishpala.

This book also provides historical context for the Vedic era, when barter system, money and wedding customs were still developing. Also, can anyone believe that prosthesis had

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advance in Vedic times? Yes, it had! The eponymous heroine of the novel got her prosthetic leg from the Ashwini Devata and fought against her enemies.

The novel starts thus: *"I am the queen! This will be my throne!" The seven-year-old chirped, leaping from the middle of the porch towards the broken mortar which served as a mock throne."*

A Playful Comparison:

The popular writer in this genre, Devdutt Pattanaik in his book, 'Ramayana v/s Mahabharata: My playful comparison' has analyzed the two Hindu epics and has highlighted the similarities and differences between the two epics. Each of the chapters in his book gives us an intriguing conclusion. Regardless of the religion, it discusses all the facts of religions focusing primarily on Hinduism because of the genre. Buddhism, Jainism, and occasionally Christianity and Islam are all discussed and emphasized the similarities and differences with proper justification.

One can get the figure that Pattanaik reinforces the Varna system, which was based on the transmission of profession from generations. Also, Varna system had created an economic sense in the olden days.

An excerpt from his work: *"Nature values every female greatly – as it is in her womb that it does not value all males, just the strongest and the fittest."*

One of the chapters in his book brings the mirror image of a celibate man and chaste woman. "What a woman acquires through chastity, a man acquires through celibacy – a power that makes the women a Sati and the man a Siddha." But he opines that sometimes domesticates women and reinforces patriarchy.

End of an epoch:

'Yuganta – the end of an epoch' written by Irawati Karve was written originally in Marathi and translated to English.

This is a fifty-year-old book which is a collection of essays. Even today it is so fresh because these essays are just the elucidations of how a layman could explore Mahabharata and put forth his questions. In all of the chapters, a clear outcome that anybody could feel is the ineffectiveness of human effort.

“One did one’s duty not because of any expected reward, but because one wanted to live with honor and die with honor.”

Also, she makes an effort to make readers understand to accept people as they are. She writes, “She died as she lived, without bending” while writing about Kunti’s demise.

The curse:

Aditi Banerjee in her book, “The curse of Gandhari” makes a successful attempt in retelling Jayaa through Gandhari’s stance. Also, the way she shifts between the past and present is a treat for readers. She writes an impactful prologue thus: *“But there was once a time when Krishna was the one in pursuit; once, he was the one chasing a woman, in a different forest when he was much older; when a gem encrusted crown had replaced the peacock feather in his hair. The woman he chased was emaciated and old, yet elegant still, despite the white gauze bandage wound tight around her eyes, blindfolding her. She was running away from him, desperate to avoid him. But he would not relent. He had come to confront her – Gandhari, the erstwhile queen of Hastinapur – **one last time, to prepare her to die.**”*

Culminating Notion:

There are renowned authors like Kavita Kane, Chitra Banerjee Divakaruni, Kevin Missal, Amish Tripathi, Sharath Komarraju, and others who write in this genre. When these books are weighed on a balance scale, the literary values of the novel weighs more compared to that of philosophical and spiritual values. But, it seems okay when the reader is ready for his treat!

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Historical fiction is less history and more literature. The focus is on how their message relates to our lives today or the timeless human experience, not whether they can be instructive about history.

If you want to learn history, study history; if you want to explore the range of human experiences& emotions, read fiction.

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16. FOLK LITERATURE

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Abstract:

The literature of India is incredibly diverse and spans thousands of years. It encompasses wide range of genres, styles, and languages. Among various kinds of literature, India has a rich tradition of regional literature in languages such as Bengali, Marathi, Gujarati, Malayalam, Kannada, Telugu and Punjabi. Each region has its own unique literary heritage, with notable authors and works.

Introduction:

Folk literature, oral literature or orator is a genre of literature that is spoken or sung as opposed to that which is written, though much oral literature has been transcribed. Folk literature is really awesome. It is based on local lifestyles, festivals, emotions etc. That's why it is very heart touching. It makes us feel as if we are sleeping on our mother's lap.

History:

It is transmitted from word of mouth. Until about 4000 BCE all literature was oral, but, beginning in the years between 4000 and 5000 BCE, writing developed both in Egypt and in Mesopotamian civilization at Sumer. From that time on, there are records not only of practical matters such as law and business but increasingly of written literature.

Nature:

Each group of people, no matter how small or large, has

handled its folk literature in its own way. Depending on transmission from person to person and being subject to the skill or the lack of skill of those who pass it on and to the many influences, physical or social, that consciously or unconsciously affect the tradition, what may be observed is a history of continual change.

What is Folklore?

Folklore is a collection of fictional stories about animals and people, of cultural myths, jokes, songs, tales, and even quotes. It is a description of culture, which has been passed down verbally from generation to generation, though many are now in written form.

Folklore depicts the way main characters manage their everyday life events, including conflicts or crises. The story of folk tradition and knowledge is called folkloristic.

Types of folklore:

Folk Tales: The oral fictional tale, from whatever ultimate origin, is practically universal both in time and place. Folklore travels with great ease from one story letter to another. Since a particular story is characterized by its verbal form, it passes language boundaries without difficulty.

Tall Tales: A tall tale is a story with unbelievable elements, related as if it were true and factual. Some tall tales are exaggerations of actual events, for example fish stories (“The fish that got away”) such as, “That fish was so big, why I tell ya, and it nearly sank the boat when I pulled it in!” Events are often told in a way that makes the narrator seem to have been a part of the story; the tone is generally good-natured.

Fables: Fables are short stories that teach moral lessons through The use of animal characters. They often end with a concise moral or proverb, such as Aesop’s fables.

Myths: Myths are traditional stories that explain the origins of the world, natural phenomenon, and the actions of gods and heroes. They often involve supernatural beings and are

deeply rooted in religious or spiritual beliefs.

Legends: Are stories that are based on historical events or figures but have been embellished over time. They often feature heroic or supernatural elements and are passed down as true accounts of the past.

Fairy Tales: Fairy tales are imaginative stories that typically involve magical creatures, enchantments, and moral lessons. They often feature common motifs such as princesses, witches, talking animals, and quests.

Ballads: Ballads are narrative songs that tell stories of love, tragedy, or heroic deeds. They are often passed down orally and have a strong musical element.

Proverbs and Sayings: Proverbs and sayings are short, concise statements that convey wisdom or advice. They are often used to teach moral lessons or provide guidance in everyday life.

These are just a few examples of the many types of folklore that exists around the world. Each type has its own unique characteristic and cultural significance, contributing to the rich tapestry of folk literature.

Conclusion:

In conclusion, folk literature is a treasure trove of stories that have been passed down through generations. It serves as a cultural and moral compass, reflecting the values and beliefs of different societies. Its oral tradition and imaginative elements make it a unique and timeless form of storytelling that continues to captivate audiences worldwide.

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17. ANIMAL FOLKTALES BECOME MIRRORS OF HUMAN SOCIETY

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Abstract

A Folktale is a story forming a part of an oral tradition. Folktales are generally passed down from one generation to another and often take on the characteristics of the time and place in which they are told. The stories have themes, morals, issues which deal with everyday issue. It has a certain educative purpose. Often through folktales, we are given a glimpse into a real world where fantasy and reality meet.

There are many Folktales which include Animal stories. The use of animals as human characters is to highlight the attitudes and behavior of people in a way which reflects the actions in real life. Animals are used to convey message to audience without seeming to personalize issue or point certain individual characteristics. The use of animal imagery makes it possible for people to understand the relevance of the story being told due to simplified animal characters.

The paper discusses Animal stories of *A Jackal and a Fox* (Uttar Pradesh), *The Crane and the Crow* (Kerala) and *Story of the Pebet* (Manipur). Through these three stories, it emphasizes on values, human rights, sustainable development. These

stories also embody popular attitude, beliefs, customs, tradition and values of the society. Folktales also develop awareness towards the society. We also notice the survival techniques used by the powerless, marginalized and silenced to overcome the power structure through the stories. Thus, these Animal stories become mirrors of human society.

Keywords: Animal stories, Folktales, society.

Folktales are timeless narratives that form an integral part of oral tradition, passed down through generations and reflecting the essence of their specific time and culture. Folktales do not have an individual author. These stories embody themes, morals, and everyday issues, serving an educative purpose. Embedded within the tales are insights into managing class and caste structures, addressing taboos, and contributing to the broader social fabric. As we delve into these folktales, we are transported to a realm where reality intertwines with fantasy, offering us valuable glimpses into diverse and captivating worlds.

Animal tales are a diverse category of folktales where animals assume human characteristics. These tales cleverly mirror human attitudes and behaviors, effectively presenting real-life actions in a captivating and relatable manner. Animals are used as tools to convey messages to audience without seeming to personalize issue or point certain individual. And also animal imagery makes it possible for people to understand the relevance of the story being told due to the simplified character of the animal.

One such animal story is *A Jackal and a Fox (Uttar Pradesh)* where both play the role of a trickster, when linked to the animal world. Both the Jackal and the Fox appear in

manipulative roles. In the story, we see an unusual duel of wits between them. Here the two tricksters come into conflict with each other. The jackal takes possession of the house of the fox and sends her away. The fox has no power to confront authority. The lion in the story represents power and authority. Jackal using his cunning nature changes the situation to his own advantage and is able to play tricks on the king of the beasts the lion too. The role of the deceitful and greedy trickster is often played by the devious jackal and he is traditionally treated with suspicion and distrust. Through the story, we see how society is structured with the powerful and dominant at the top and marginalized at the bottom. Jackal's techniques are strategies that the marginal use to survive. And can also flip over the situation through cunningness, treachery and intelligence. Thus, animal stories reflect human world strategies of survival.

The next story, *The Crane and the Crow (Kerala)* is a tale about an aggressive visitor who ends up actually murdering the host's children. The story is from the extreme southern state of Kerala.

Because the behavior described breaks so many taboos, it is not surprising that the characters used are birds. However the personalities and language used clearly imply human parallels.

We see clear status contrasts existing between the two birds. The Crow is black and its garments never look clean, lives in a house made of cow dung which washes away in rain, The Crane is white and so are its clothes, lives in sturdy and beautifully smooth house.

From the story, we can connect it to the prevailing class

system of the time. In the beginning we see how the Crow is being oppressed by the crane. Crane shows a power of authority, and later the Crow takes revenge by lying to the crane and feast upon its young ones and slowly escapes in the morning. In the end we see how the crane uses strategies to teach the Crow a lesson.

From the above story we can infer that when man commits acts of injustice or if he violates the laws of nature, he will only have to suffer the consequences.

The third story is *The Story of the Pebet (Manipur)*. Pebet is a small bird found in the jungles of Manipur. The story is about a Cat that deceives the mother bird Pebet, who trusts the cat with her children. But the cat's real intention of course, is to eat the tasty young ones that are growing in this mothers nest. The cat's deceptive strategy is it's pretence of being a holy man. He wears a chain of prayer beads, pretends to be vegetarian. It is a wolf in sheep's clothing. The clever mother bird in the story sees through the cat's disguise and focuses on warning and protecting her children from the evil eyes. Here the cat represents the powerful India which has strength to dominate and oppress using its size. Whereas, the bird represent weak and marginalized Manipur. We see a society dominated by the strong and powerful and how the powerful oppress the marginalized. And how Manipur faced violence in recent times.

The story is extremely powerful and talks about the possibility of resistance. As the Pebet overcomes the cat, we see how Manipur can overcome the power structure. The Pebet becomes a trickster which is often found in the animal stories. The story has a strong political undertone. This story also showcases how intelligence, cunningness and

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shrewdness are tools for survival to overcome the powerful. Thus, all the three stories we see the survival techniques used by the powerless, marginalized and silenced to overcome the power structure. These stories carry important messages to the readers of today. It emphasizes on values, human rights, sustainable development. These stories embody popular attitudes, beliefs, customs, tradition and values of the society. It develops awareness through these folktales. And hence, these Animal stories become mirrors of human society.

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18. SIGNIFICANCE OF VIRGINIA WOOLF'S "A ROOM OF ONE'S OWN"

**"A Woman must have money and A Room of her own if
she is to write fiction"**

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Meaning

Feminism is an interdisciplinary approach to issues of equality and equity based on gender, gender expression, gender identity, sex, and sexuality as understood through social theories and political activism. Historically, feminism has evolved from the critical examination of inequality between the sexes to a more nuanced focus on the social and performative constructions of gender and sexuality.

Introduction

The feminist movement, also known as the women's movement, refers to a series of social movements and political campaigns for radical and liberal reforms on women's issues created by the inequality between men and women. Such issues were women's liberation, reproductive rights, domestic violence, maternity leave, equal pay, women's suffrage, sexual harassment, and sexual violence. The movement's priorities have expanded since its beginning in the 1800's, and vary among nations and communities. Priorities range from opposition to female genital mutilation in one country, to opposition to the glass ceiling in another. Feminism in parts of the Western world has been an

ongoing movement since the turn of the century. During its inception, feminism has gone through a series of four high moments termed Waves.

Stages of Feminism

The First-wave feminism (1848-1920) was oriented around the station of middle- or upper-class white women and involved suffrage in political equality, education, right to property, organizational leadership, and marital freedoms. Mary Wollstonecraft is the founder of feminism.

The Second-wave feminism (1963-1980) attempted to further combat social and cultural inequalities. Although the first wave of feminism involved mainly middle-class white women, the second wave brought in women of different social classes, women of colour, and women from other developing nations that were seeking solidarity. This wave came as a response to the experiences of women after World War II. Mary shelly, Bronte Sisters & Jane Austen were famous writers of that period.

The Third-wave feminism (1980-1990) continued to address the financial, social, and cultural inequalities of women in business and in their home lives, and included renewed campaigning for greater influence of women in politics and media. In reaction to political activism, feminists have also had to maintain focus on women's reproductive rights, such as the right to abortion. "A Room of one's own "(1829) is widely considered "The first modernist text of feminist criticism." by Virginia Woolf.

The Fourth-wave feminism (2012 -Present day) examines the interlocking systems of power that contribute to the social stratification of traditionally marginalized groups, as well as the world around them and with a focus on sexual harassment, body shaming, and rape culture, among other issues. A key component was the use of social media to

highlight and address these concerns.

A Room of One's Own

Let me introduce you to Adeline Virginia Woolf, the Third-wave feminism English writer born on 25th January, 1882. She is considered one of the most innovative modernist writers of 20th century authors and a pioneer in the use of stream of consciousness as a narrative device, central subjects of the 1970's movement of feminist movement, works translated more than 50 languages, pioneer for inspiring feminism and been subject for plays, novels and films. She was a daughter of Leslie Stephen, the founder of the Oxford Dictionary of Biography and knighted for services to literature and gave her to run his substantial library. Her notable works were *Mrs Dalloway* (1925), *To the Lighthouse* (1927), *Orlando* (1928), *A Room of One's Own* (1929), *The Waves* (1931).

According to Virginia Woolf, centuries of prejudice, financial and educational disadvantages have inhibited women's creativity. She delivered a lecture "A Room of One's Own" at a college of the fictional university Oxbridge (a combination of Oxford and Cambridge) and throughout the story we will meet a few Marys, most of whom are author surrogates or fictional characters based on the author.

The narrator begins by narrating her day at a college of the fictional university Oxbridge (a combination of Oxford and Cambridge). Trying to compose her lecture, she seizes upon some important thought and rushes across one of the college lawns but is stopped by a Beadle, a guard, who tells her that the lawn is reserved for Fellows and Scholars. She is shut out of several other areas in the same way before going to a lunch party, where she is inspired by the bright conversation of the men and women there. Later, she eats dinner at the fictional women's college Fernham was surely basic compared to the

lunch at the main campus. The fictional women's college Fernham, the meal was quite different, the fare simple and the conversation gossipy and uninteresting. On other her day, the narrator realizes that women have been shut out of education, financial and intellectual legacy that men have always had access to.

The next day, the narrator goes to the British Library and finds that it is a masculine institution. There were shelves of writing by men about women, but finds that men have used their literature and scholarship to affirm the inferiority of women mostly to protect their own superiority and portray women in certain ways in order to keep them as, effectively, second-class citizens.

After dinner, the narrator catches up with her friend Mary Seton, a science teacher at Fernham College. The conversation soon turns to women's poverty and how England's social and legal structures have held women back. When she walks back to her hotel, the narrator stew on this troubling cultural legacy. It's such a shame that women have been excluded from the wealth and traditions enjoyed by men and how might have this affect the minds of female writers.

Back Home in London, the narrator heads to the British Museum to do some research. She wants to know once and for all, why women are so poor. As she makes her way through a huge pile of books about women, she notices that they're all written by men, and all these male experts have wildly differing opinions about women, some of which are highly offensive. At lunch, she flips through the newspaper and thinks about the patriarchy. At the end the narrator couldn't find a conclusive answer to the question of women's poverty, disappointed and humiliated in male dominated society and when she has to pay lunch bill, oh! The joy of financial independence when she pays money for lunch.

She thanks to the generosity of her aunt, the late Mary Beton with an inheritance of five hundred pounds a year – which would give a woman financial independence. Once bitter and enslaved to low paying jobs, the narrator is now free to be creative and not to depend on a man.

Woolf's next move is to consider what women themselves have written in history of women's poverty, not dodgy opinions but she finds grim time for women. They were controlled by their families or husbands, mostly illiterate confined to the home and often abused and needs. The narrator imagines that a fictional sister 'Judith Shakespeare' of William Shakespeare was born with the same genius, the same potential to become a great writer as her brother. But she is shut off from the opportunities her brother enjoys: grammar-school education, the chance to become an actor in London, the opportunity to earn a living in the Elizabethan theatre but Woolf's 'Judith' deprived of opportunity is seduced by an actor-manager in the London playhouses, falls pregnant, and ends up committing suicide because of poverty and misery.

It's a depressing thought experiment, but a realistic one. Most of the women who did manage to write in the 1600's were off course rich and childless. They were also sneered at for their efforts and became very bitter as a result.

But then we have Aphra Behn, first professional middle class woman writer in England, who had some success in the 1600's 'for it was she who earned them the right to speak their minds. 'She managed to make a living from writing, which was a milestone. Her pioneering efforts gave women's writing a sense of dignity. So, by the middle of the 1700's, middle class women had begun to write. Thus, a literary tradition for women was finally established. This paved the way for icons like Jane Austen wrote novels; Emily Bronte's genius was better-suited to poetic plays than to novels,

while George Eliot would have made full use of her talents as a biographer and historian rather than as a novelist. So even here, women had to bend their talents into a socially acceptable form, and at the time this meant writing novels. Thanks to all these women, whose work is still widely enjoyed today, Virginia Woolf can encourage her audience to go out and make a living by writing.

As the narrator peruses her shelves, she is impressed by the number of novels, all written by women. In the 1800's, few of these women would have had rooms of their own. No doubt they were also constantly interrupted by their family members, which was probably why they wrote novels.

Virginia Woolf's title of her essay: **'a woman must have money and a room of her own if she is to write fiction.'** She goes on to specify that an inheritance of five hundred pounds a year from her aunt– which would give a woman financial independence – is more important than women getting the vote (women had only attained completely equal suffrage to men in 1928, the same year that Woolf delivered her lectures).

Here, Woolf appeals to her audience that women's literature needs a stronger tradition and must write authentically, be courageously, original, and honour their literary writings and argues should be praised by all women for showing that the professional woman writer could become a reality.

Aphra Behn, writing in the seventeenth century, was an important breakthrough for all women 'for it was she who earned them the right to speak their minds.' Earlier women writers were too constrained by their insecurity – as women writing in a male-dominated literary world – and this leads to a 'flaw' in their work. Woolf addresses the status of women, and women artists in particular, in this famous essay, which asserts that a woman must have money and a room of her own if she is to write.

According to Woolf, centuries of prejudice and financial and educational disadvantages have inhibited women's creativity. The social gender matter, the presence of a patriarchal community, the inequalities in education, the fact that women cannot appear in history, or the scarcity of the appearance of women in the history are the main things told in the book. In order to be creative in terms of intellectuality, women need a room of their own.

The patriarchy is still alive and women have their work out for them and for future **“Honour your literary mothers and keep working and writing even if it's a struggle.”**

Feminist theory now aims to interrogate inequalities and inequities along the intersectional lines of ability, class, gender, race, sex, and sexuality, and feminists seek to effect change in areas where these intersectionality's create power inequity. Intellectual and academic discussion of these inequities allows our students to go into the world aware of injustices and to work toward changing unhealthy dynamics in any scenario.

Feminist political activist's' campaign in areas such as reproductive rights, domestic violence, fairness, social justice, and workplace issues such as family medical leave, equal pay, and sexual harassment and discrimination.

Conclusion

A Room of One's Own is considered a landmark feminist text and is itself a significant critical contribution to the subject of women and literature. Though some of Woolf's suggestions and methods have been questioned in the seventy years since its publication, it holds an important place in the British and feminist literary canon as an essay that empowered generations of women writers to pick up their pens.

In the 21st century, society has realized that women must be independent and make choices for themselves in education,

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social works, jobs, careers, and couple life in public as well as at home. To make the society developed and sustainable, all forms of patriarchal oppressions, such as sexism, racism, class oppressions, imperialism, etc. must be eradicated from the society. Which paved towards feminist fiction, feminist non-fiction, and feminist poetry which created new interest in women writing? It also prompted a general re valuation of women's historical and academic contributions in response to the belief that women's lives and contributions have been underrepresented as areas of scholarly interest.

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19. AN ANALYSIS OF MAHASWETHA DEVI'S “RUDALI”

*An epitomic portrait of misery, exploitation, and
suffering of the marginalized women.*

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Abstract:

The title “Rudali” refers to Shanichari’s profession as a professional mourner.

Rudali is a novella written by Mahaswetha Devi and is centered on the protagonist, Shanichari, marginalized woman in rural India. It explores themes of human identity, female independence, and exploitation.

Shanichari faces maltreatment and setback due to her lower caste status, but she eventually defeats the odds to prevail over her exploiters. The story focuses on the trivial and often painful experiences of life in a rural Dalit woman. The main characters Sanichari and Bikhini, both embody the struggles of such communities.

Shanichari is forced to take up the profession of a ‘Rudali’, which is a female mourner who cries and wails at funerals. Through her sorrowful but enduring journey, Shanichari is eventually able to find an inner strength that gives her the will power and courage to move on with her life and break the social and cultural norms that keep her oppressed. Throughout the story, Mahaswetha Devi depicts how in a male-dominated society, women are faced with nightmarish forms of marginalization and maltreatment. They are subjected to unfair labor practice, economic deprivation, and even sometimes physical violence.

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Based on this short story by Mahasweta Devi. A feature film was directed by Kalpana Lajmi, on the same name “Rudali” in 1993 acted by Dimple Kapadia. It was also adopted and produced as a play in Hindi by Usha Ganguli of the Calcutta theatre group ‘Ranga Karmee’ in December 1992.

Introduction

Later during the post-colonial writers like Premchand, Mulk Raj Anand, R.K. Narayan, Anitha Desai, Mahasweta Devi have incorporated realism in their novels. They highlighted the problems and woes of common people in India.

Mahasweta Devi was born on 14th January 1926 in Dhacca, she shared literary tradition with her parents. She completed her master’s degree in English literature from Calcutta University, and soon started contributing to literary journals. She was the recipient of many prestigious awards such as Jnana pith Award (1995), the Magsaysay award (1996), Padmashri, Sahitya Academy Award, etc.,

Some of Mahasweta Devi’s works include Jhansi Rani, Amrita Sanchay (1964), Andhan Malik (1967), Breast Giver, Five Pledges, Imaginary Maps. Mother of 1084, Rudali, and The Activist Writings of Mahasweta Devi etc., she has written and published more than forty books including novels and stories in Bangla. Her literary works are a comment on simplistic lifestyles of the tribes as well as on their suffering and exploitation.

“Rudali” is a powerful indictment of socio-economic system in India. It also comes to as attack on the vestiges of feudalism in rural India. It is ironical that in India, woman is regarded as a representation of the Goddess, yet she is exploited and marginalized by upper classes. It records the metamorphoses of Sanichari.

Key words:

Indictment, vestiges, feudalism, marginalized.

Rudali

Rudali is a famous story by Mahasweta Devi. The story is about an afflicted, oppressed, marginalized Dalit woman of eastern Indian village whose life has been the saga of suffering and pain. She is the victim of dictomy where woman is worshipped as goddess and whipped as slave. It revolves around the life of a poor low caste village women who are twice marginalized. She is women as well as an untouchable. Her life-story is an ironic tale of exploitation and struggle for Survival. She was Sanichari, born on Saturday, and hence her presence everywhere is symbolic of bad omen and bad luck. The story begins with the description of Tahad village, ganjus and dushads are in the majority. Sanichari is a ganju who belongs to a poor family.

Her mother-in-law would often remark that, being born on an unlucky day of the week doomed to suffer, it is not fate, it's an economic condition, and the problems of sanichari were common to her class, caste and gender. When her mother-in-law died sanichari didn't cry. At that time, her husband and her brother were in jail because of Malik-Mahajan Ramavatar Singh. Enraged at the loss of some wheat, he had all the young dushed and ganju males of the village locked up. Her mother-in-law died in great pain, crying out, over and over, 'food, give me food!' at night, in the pouring rain. Then sanichari was hard pressed to carry out the necessary rituals before daybreak, with no grain in the house, and no menfolk to help lay out the body. She was so busy that there was no time to cry. The old women had given her so much trouble that even if sanichari had tried to cry she wouldn't have been able to bring out any tears. Within three years, the brother-in-law and his wife were dead too. "There was no

crying over those deaths either. Grief must have hardened into stone within them, at the frequent deaths in the family was one to weep and worried about how to burn the corpses and feed the neighbours cheaply at the shradh?”. So, the harsh realities of poverty, exploitation and death are exposed in brutal detail with all their attendant degradation.

Sanichari and her husband worked as partners, both working equally hard, but together for home and livelihood. She left her six-year-old son at home and went to the malik's estate where she chopped wood, fetched fodder for the cattle, and at harvest season worked shoulder to shoulder with her husband. Together the two of them erected a hut on the piece. He planned a vegetable patch in their courtyard, but her husband died of cholera after drinking the milk used for bathing shiva idol in the fair at Tohri, at that time she barely had time to cry. She had to register the fact when the panda of the shiva temple at Tohri demanded that she made ritual offerings before returning to her village. Even spartan offering of sand and sattu (gram flour) cost her precious rupee and a quarter. And once she returned to her village. Mohanlal, the priest of Ramavatar's presiding deity, scoffed: In order to appease Mohanlal she was forced into debt of Ramavatar. She received Rs. 20 and put her thumbprint on a paper stating that she would repay Rs. 50 through bonded labour on his fields over the next 5 years and after paying for budhua's father's shradh, she was so hard pressed to feed her little son that she never had time to cry for her husband.

Sanichari's son budhua was a sensitive, thoughtful and gentle, caring both towards his mother and his wife but he also died of tuberculosis and her daughter-in-law went away leaving behind her crying son. With the child in her arms, she busied herself cremating Budhua and searching for her bahu in all this she could not cry for her son.

At this devastating stage, she went and met Dulan who is

a mentor and guide to her. He found him a job at railway station. She brought her grandson Haora as best as she could. When he turned 14 years, she took him to the new Mallik Mahajan Lachman Singh, and pleaded him for a job to Haora which she finally got. The boy worked hard for the first few months gradually, he grew bored and restless with the of job. Ultimately, he ran away with the magic-show lot. She went from one market place to another, from one fair ground to another looking for him. It did not occur to her to cry for him.

Later, she met Bhikhni who was a childhood playmate. The relationship between Sanichari and Bikhni who re-discovered each other as aging, lonely, both were poor, struggling to find means of survival. They decided to team up, both had been abandoned by members of their family, by pairing up they provide each other with company and pool their resources to ensure a degree of economic stability.

Sanichari invited Bikhni to share her little house. It would be company for her; a place for Bikhni to stay in response, Bikhni offered her nest-egg: twenty rupees. For some days the two of them ate off Bikhni's money. When that ran out Sanichari felt as if the sky had fallen on her head.

Once again, Sanichari went to Dulan for advice, at very stressful juncture of her life, Dulan intervened to advise, help, educate, and enlighten. Dulan embodied the resistant will, the sharp intelligence, the irreverence, the cynicism, and the cunning that the subaltern used to subvert the total control of the masters.

It was Dulan who at every stage contributed to the growing empowerment of sanichari, how to adapt and cope. He presented her with survival strategy, a way of turning the situation around so that she was using the system instead of just being used by it.

He suggested that they hired themselves out as Rudali's

when she showed her apprehensions about this profession, Dulan made her understand that no one was good or bad for appetite of stomach: and said Bhairab singh of Barohi had just died, his son killed him and they needed Rudalis to wail over the corpse because the family members of rich are too busy trying to find out the keys to safe. They forgot all about tears. Nathani sing who owned all his wealth to his mother, was doing nothing to cure her, but planned to spend thirty thousand on her funeral. Gangadhar sing... was stingy enough to use Dalda instead of pure ghee on the funeral pyre of his uncle? She would have to feed herself by selling their tears. Once the women executed this job successfully, he gave them tips on how to keep themselves, informed about potential jobs by keeping an ear open on trips to the market places.

Rich people spend huge sum of money on death ceremonies, just to gain prestige or when someone died in a malik Mahajan house holder, the amount of money spend on the death ceremony immediately raised the prestige of the family... now, sanichari and Bikhni have become professional team and a social ritual evolved into a profession, a business.

The women laid down their terms, and the Gomathas had no choice but to accept, since the team was in a great demand after their spectacular debut. Gradually their reputation grew. Everyone wanted them as Rudalis- sure they were not cheap, but they really did provide their money's worth really wept and wail and hit their head in the dust. ... After some days there came the news of Bikhni's death, sanichani felt a land slide within. But many deaths, deceptions, injustice, had hardened her endurance and self-control: Sanichari had survived so much grief; she'll survive the loss of Bikhni. She's devastated, but didn't cry: "Money, rich, new clothes- without getting these in returns, tears are a useless luxury. Dulan also advised her to offer an additional service

which mean interacting with prostitutes in Thori. Dulan's reasoning, his insistence that the prostitutes were victims just like themselves, Dual's encouragement reassured her, and thereafter, the Sanichari, we saw, was confident uninhabited, canny. Criticized, accused, and condemned the upper classes. Highlighting their moral corruption, greed, and hypocrisy, after her discussion with Dulan. Sanichari's lingering inhibition was removed. She was confident, in control, empowered. At the end of the novel, she bought hundred whores as Rudalis.

Conclusion:

In conclusion, Mahaswetha Devi's Rudali serves as a perfect example of exploitation and suffering that the rural marginalized populations of India frequently face.

The text itself is a critique of the system. It is not only a story of an endless suffering of poor low-caste women, but it also voices a strong and the ill-treatment of women. Though they belong to lower and weaker sections of society, oppressed, and exploited they always put a resistance to the patriarchal system. Shanichari's story shows that through courage, determination and hardwork, women can overcome the obstacles of life and craft a future for them that provides both in material security and dignity.

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20. THE DEAD TRUTH: EXPLORING THE ELEMENTS OF POST-TRUTH IN STEPHEN KING'S WILLA

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Abstract

Through this paper we aim to use an analysis of the short story Willa, to bring to the limelight the societal aspect of the post-truth theory. Chained to its original stature as little more than an emerging political phenomenon, the post-truth theory, and its contributions concerning societal relations have been grossly overlooked. This paper functions on the findings that the modern human society holds in high esteem the truth, while passionately embracing the lie, that in such a society lying moreover than becoming the norm achieves a status of requirement for societal survival, or more accurately the survival of the society. Through an analysis of Willa, we were able to perceive the creation of a post-truth society, its protection through active misinformation and the dissuasion of the seeking of truth, and finally the viewing of said society through the lens of objectivity, shattering the illusions that held together the fabric of the society. All this King does deftly, while maintaining his usual style of the supernatural and the macabre. The crux of the paper is based around the societal aspect of the post-truth theory as we believe the societal workings and ultimately, impacts,

of it is where the theory begins, and is what eventually led to the development and acceptance of the theory of post-truth as a wide-spread political phenomenon of the modern world.

Keywords: - Societal, post-truth, illusions, objectivity, misinformation

'You don't see what's right in front of your eyes'

-The opening lines of Willa-

The idea of post-truth, functions on the belief that the world has surpassed in every facet of its existence the 'necessity' for truth. While it began as a political term, to denote the prevalence of deceit and dishonesty in the field of politics, the term eventually, and unfortunately, became viable enough to extend its existence to the wider world. Post-truth, as a phenomenon, is said to have come into existence due to the inability of people to accept facts that are detrimental or traumatic to accept which leads the group to accept anything but the truth, which could be a well-crafted house of lies or blatant reality bending. We see the post-truth in Willa through the former.

'Willa' opens to a group of stranded train passengers, who are waiting for the next train to take them to their destination, as their train had derailed. This is the reality we are offered. We are then introduced to David, a banker and one of the passengers, who is trying to find his fiancée, Willa, who has wandered off, he asks his fellow passengers about her, but none are too keen to help as not many are fond of Willa. Finally, believing that she's head into the nearby town David decides to go looking for her. Travelling through the night amidst staring wolves, broken beer bottles and a not so lively town, David arrives at the local bar, named 26, where a band called Derailers is playing for the night. It was inside 26, away from the music and dancing, in a quiet corner that David found Willa. But his happiness at having found his

fiancée is short lived as she was adamant to not return to the train station to wait for the next train. The reason for her stubbornness was simple- there was no train coming, because they were dead.

This is where the post-truth world of 'Willa' peels back, and we are met with the revealing of the 'true' reality. The reality, the character of David believes is that he and his fiancée Willa, along with a few other unlucky passengers were derailed from their train, and are now waiting for Amtrak to send another train to get them to their destination, this, he believes is the truth. However the truth, the objective truth that is, is that David, Willa and all his fellow passengers had died in the train's derailing, derailing that happened almost 20 years ago. Here we see the sociological element of post-truth, as considering the difficulty in believing the truth that he is now a spectre who has no place among the living, David instead chooses to believe, along with his fellow passengers that he is simply stuck at the railway station as his train has derailed.

King has, through the use of a few devices and instances, made it possible to find the truth through an analysis of the setting of the story itself. The first instance is of the permeating rank odour in the railway station, strange for an odour to permeate in an open space, but it is given only an afterthought at first glance, and is only revealed later towards the end of the story that the odour is due to the station being sealed up but the spectres never noticed as believing themselves to be alive and stranded they only saw an open railway station. The second instance is of the wolves, David's path to the town is littered with packs of wolves, and he is warned by his fellow passengers to be wary of wolves, but when he is eventually faced with a pack of wolves they simply stare at him, keeping an almost reverential distance, it is a widely held belief among many people of North-America

that canines have the ability to see ghosts, King, famous for using popular beliefs and myths in his fiction used this particular superstition to allude the reality, that David is a ghost and the wolves can see him. But sociologically, the wolves also serve the function of outliers, of those people who see the socio-economic structure of the world for what it is and choose to stay out of it, thereby making them strange and unapproachable to us, much like the hippies or beatniks. The next instance is of David kicking a beer bottle a few paces out of boredom, but when he peeks back he sees the bottle in the spot that it already was, as in reality he had never kicked it in the first place, he simply believed to have kicked it, a comparable scenario is the widespread belief by the American people that Iraq did in fact have weapons of nuclear potential, while there was no substantial evidence to back up such a claim, only in retrospect was the general public able to admit that they were wrong. The final instance is perhaps the cover band playing at the bar 26, by the name of “Derailers”, an odd name surely, here once again we see King using popular mythology in play, that in die music groups from small towns usually name themselves after something famous or notable that happened in the town they were from. The name Derailers is a reference to the derailling of the train that killed all it’s passengers, 20 years ago, over the years the story lost it’s element of tragedy and the band took it as it’s name. Such instances of the truth are also available in the real world in a post-truth society, but we are reluctant to seek them out, because of fear of losing our sense of security, our comforts or maybe even our sense of identity.

The final segment of the story is David and Willa trying to convince their fellow travellers that they are in fact deceased, as the old boarded up station is about to be demolished and they don’t know what would happen to the spectres once the

station is demolished. But the others are reluctant to listen, and some are in fact downright hostile towards Willa and David. When they return to the station a character by the name of Palmer asks them if they brought back cigarettes for him, to which Willa responds that it would be difficult to do so since they were dead, but what is noteworthy is that David observes that Palmer had no difficulty believing him, he had known all along, but in the same strain Palmer laughs it off as an odd joke. This particular phenomenon is prevalent in the post-truth world, as the reality bending done by the general populace to suit their narratives can be broken by themselves if their self or sense of self were ever perceived to be in threat, but in any other sense they would be unwilling to accept the truth for what it is, even though the members of such a society most certainly are very aware of the truth.

The second instance is of the hostility displayed towards Willa and David, with the other travellers shouting, screaming, arguing and even shouting curse words at the both of them for speaking the truth- that they are dead. We must keep in mind that they are already aware of the fact that they are dead, but they still violently and vehemently disagree and try to actively push out the voices that speak against their narrative. This is a most curious phenomenon in a post-truth society, as the truth is not the real problem to them, it is the visible proclamation of it, especially from outside parties, which they will deem an attack on themselves and retort passionately. Such an example can be seen among many religions that ask for blind obedience from their follower, as any questioning of the doctrine is met with shunning, punishment and sometimes both. The example also ties up well with a final instance taken from the scene. When Willa and David are posed with the question of how they did in fact die, they are mum, as they do not remember,

suddenly a child among the passengers speaks out that the derailed train had exploded and that they had died in the ensuing fire, only to be suddenly slapped into silence by the child's mother on the pretext that she was lying, such is what happens in the world as well, with communities enforcing their perspectives on their own who dare to speak out.

With this the paper has reached its conclusion, as we believe that the instances, allusions and examples cited make clear of the element of post-truth in Stephen King's "Willa", and of the sociological aspects of a post-truth society in reference to it.

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21. DISABILITY STUDIES : WAY TO AN INCLUSIVE LITERATURE

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Disability

Disability has forever evoked a sense of enigma and has its own share of prejudice and bias attached to it. It is something that all has experienced at one point in life but have not necessarily understood. From times immemorial, 'people have felt compelled both to stare at the disabled people in their midst and then to turn their heads in discomfort' (Berger:12). For centuries civilizations have oppressed disabled people and subjugated them to a marginal position. They have been isolated from the mainstream society, incarcerated, written wrongly about, operated upon in the guise of 'treatment', implanted with devices without their consent, institutionalized and controlled to such a degree that no other marginalized group has been subjected to in the known history.

Science has contributed a lot in the transitioning of disability incidence, its prevalence among the people and its awareness by making life with serious and chronic impairments increasingly comfortable and feasible for the disabled. The United Nation's Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disability (CRPD) defines disability as 'a long-term physical, mental, intellectual or sensory impairment which in interaction with various barriers may hinder their full and effective participation in the society on an equal

basis with others' (CRPD Article-1).

Disability Studies

Disability Studies is a nascent field and an inventive area with its basis and roots in the social sciences, humanities and rehabilitation sciences. It unites a variety of ongoing work. As disability studies scholar, Lennard J. Davis proposes, 'it would be more appropriate to say that disability studies have been in the making for many years, but, like people with disabilities, has only recently recognized itself as a political, discursive entity' (Davis: 4). The framework of the field encompasses the life experiences of the disabled, the critical issues that are in need of attention, better understanding of the problems and effort to venture into integrative approaches to unify the field. This multiplicity of the diverse voices, perspectives, goals combine in shaping the field of disability studies. This emergence of the new field gives the disabled a new non- medicalised and a positive legitimacy which works both as an academic discipline and as an area of political struggle. As a relatively new discourse, disability studies struggle to find and claim space in a highly contested and distorted area. It argues for its existence and justifies its assertions. For centuries, this area unlike other fields of study such as race, gender, class has not had the academic or political visibility. Progressives in the academia might boast themselves of being sensitive to issues of race, gender and class but all have been through 'ableist' when it comes to the disabled community.

This reversal of the historic writings on the aspects of the body, disease, freakishness and so on forces the present generation of scholars in the field of disability studies to look forward towards the Feminist, Marxist, Postmodern and Cultural Studies model for comprehending a better understanding the dynamics and relation between body

and power. This was done with the sole purpose of invoking a sense of sympathy. The works evoke a high sense of inappropriateness from the scholars of the field. It is as if the whites are explaining what it is like to be black or a man explaining the difficulties faced by a woman in the society. This discredits the writer's authority to talk on the topic and at the same time it distorts the concept to the reader who will never be able to grasp the correctness of the experience as espoused by the writer in the work. As Davis reiterates that disability studies, for the most part, shuns this unequal power transaction in favour of advocacy, investigation, inquiry, archaeology, genealogy, dialectic, and deconstruction (Davis: 7).

Literary and Cultural Disability Studies

Literary and Cultural Disability Studies is such a field of study that gives an appropriate platform for such narrative maneuverings. It is a lens that explores the cultural and literary arrangements in addressing a few pertinent questions. First is the question of what constitutes the Canon? It is through canons that discipline approach to consolidate their field of study. As critic Tobin Siebers says that 'my withered limb is my compass, which directs me to newer directions' (Siebers: ii). This helps in creating an archive of discourse.

The Second question is of the way in which an art form is interpreted involving texts and contexts. A text is a direct result of the context in which it takes birth. With the aid of close reading of narratives, the attention to style and rhythm can give huge understanding about the political context in which the work was produced. All these factors 'make' the text.

The Third is the multilingual question that comprehends the enduring relationship between the disability politics and

multilingualism. It is not only the spoken language. It is a multivalent expression from all directions, different media, and different registers and so on.

Lastly, comes the question of inter disciplinarity and the problem of accommodation. Teaching disability texts, ethics of care in teaching and learning disability component, the moral politics with its varied forms of interpretations is a challenge in itself. With the baggage that the readers come with be it the preconceived notions about disability or the prejudices, the problem of accommodation is as much a pertinent question as the literary question.

The Concept of Normalcy

Statistical Historian Daniel J Kevles argues that the concept of normal was used synonymously with the word 'ideal' in the seventeenth century, as exemplified in the ideal nude body of the Venuses. This notion of 'ideal' implies that the ideal human body of the divine visualized in the art must be composed from the ideal parts of living models (Kevles). The concept of the average or the norm enters the European culture in the nineteenth century. French Statistician Adolphe Quetelet (1796-1847) noted that the law of error, used by the astronomers, could also be applied to the distribution of human features. Later Sir Francis Galton, a British Statistician binds statistics with eugenics. In its central idea stands the basis that the population can be normed. It divides the entire population into standard population which is the norm and the non standard population which is the 'abnormal'. When the idea of normality and abnormality pervaded the human physiology, it led to the assumption that humans with higher intelligence, decreased birth defects and such things became a desirable aspect in the population (Davis).

In this broad task, it can be argued that the notion of 'normal'

is neither a natural category nor is it a norm. The research in this area should aim at revisiting the historical origins of the word and analyse its present-day usage. It must delineate and reinterpret the relationship between disability and stigma. As a result, Disability Studies emerged as a field of study in the late twentieth century as a result of the disability rights movement, a flourishing interdisciplinary identity-based approach that revealed a compelling and a totally new aspect of the humanities which emphasized rights of a human as an individual. The field consciously built on the American civil rights movement. With varied forms of protests, people with various impairments contested the long-held belief about the disabled of being pitiable individuals with tragic medical problems, perpetually shrouded in darkness. Instead, they presented themselves as a unified group facing widespread discrimination.

Erving Goffman, a sociologist in his monumental work *Stigma* (1963) analyses the interactions around people including those with “abominations of the body” who are different from the expected norm in the society (Goffman: 4). In *The History of Sexuality* (1976) Michel Foucault argues about the bodies that differed from the norm. He demonstrates how in the nineteenth century bodies with ‘problems’ were “sequestered, controlled, diagnosed, and otherwise socially managed” (Foucault:15). Leslie Fiedler, a literary critic, in his seminal work *Freaks* (1978) explored the disabled bodies as “non-normative human bodies and their display for profit” (Fielder).

The relationship between biology and culture, vis-à-vis cultural constructivism, has formed a unique complication in the case of disability. In order to denounce the medical model for disability, Simi Linton in her manifesto *Claiming Disability* (1998) claims that by “refusing the medicalization of disability”. Linton argues, disability activism emphasized

how disabled people are connected, not by personal symptoms, but by “social and political circumstances that have forged us as a group” (Linton:2, 4).

As the field evolved, theorists have called for a nuanced approach, better than the social model. Leading theorist Lennard J Davis, in his book, *Bending over Backwards: Disability, Dismodernism & Other Difficult Positions* (2002) asserts that “an insistence on social construction alone was intellectually unsatisfactory” (Davis:35). Another prominent theorist Tom Shakespeare, in his work, *The Social Model of Disability* (2006) supports the idea that though social model was crucial, a newer more sophisticated approach that recognises disability as a phenomenon “requiring different levels of analysis and intervention, ranging from the medical to the socio-political” (Shakespeare: 204).

In *Enforcing Normalcy* (1995), Lennard J. Davis, put normalcy on the table of investigation. He connected the ideology of normalcy with the notions of progress and ultimately with the deadly concept of Eugenics, the nineteenth century invention. He suggested that the nineteenth century novels reinforced this idea of normalcy by showcasing heroes who are ordinary citizens, whereas the disabled characters, like that of Hippolyte in Gustave Flaubert’s *Madam Bovary* (1857) or Tiny Tim in Charles Dicken’s *A Christmas Carol* (1843) would typically be relegated to marginal roles without having much contribution to the plot of the novels.

In *Aesthetic Nervousness* (2007), Ato Quayson summarizes that disability can reveal the morality of other characters, it can show the disjuncture between thematic and narrative trajectories, it can represent moral deficit or evil, or it can be part of a sudden epiphany, it can serve as ‘hermeneutical impasse’.

Many post-colonial theorists have also cautioned against the blanket use of the experiences by the disabled and

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simply exporting western disability theories. They are of the opinion that cultural meanings attached with normalcy and disability differ from the West to the rest of the world. Clare Barker *Postcolonial Fiction and Disability* (2011), marked the interventions focused on physical, sensory, and cognitive difference in postcolonial literature. In an exhortative essay collection, *Blackness and Disability* (2012) Christopher Bell seeks to bring disability studies and African-American studies more forcefully. Critic Ellen Samuels in *Fantasies of Identification* (2014) investigates how the “disadvantaged groups have subversively performed racial, gender, or disability passing to escape oppressive institutions such as slavery” (Samuels: 11). Hence it becomes the need of the hour to develop a framework of academic deliberations where a structure might be developed to study disability studies as per the necessity and accommodating the cultural diversifications.

Conclusion

In conclusion, the above discourses help us to analyze present undercurrents of the field of study both at the national level and internationally. The research paper recognizes the relationship between the concept of normalcy and the notion of stigma that is attached with the disabled community. It envisages giving way to an inclusive literature where the disabled also stand a chance to be heard.

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22. EMERGENCE OF FEMINISM IN INDIAN LITERATURE

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Abstract:

The 'Emergence of Feminism' in Indian Literature has been a major development that has been identified in the previous decades. The literary works that have been produced during this period have helped to challenge the patriarchal norms and values that have been deeply ingrained in Indian society for centuries. Indian women writers have used their writing as a medium to express their lived experiences, critique the existing societal structures and articulate their aspirations for gender equality. The Feminist movement in India gained impulse during the 1970's and 1980's, and the literature produced during this period reflected the changing social landscape.

The early feminist literature in India was characterized by the themes of women's oppression, violence against women and the need for women's empowerment. Many feminist writers have faced criticism and opposition for their portrayal of women's experiences. However, the resilience of feminist writers in India has been evident in their continued production of literature that reflects the diverse experiences of women in India. Women empowerment in India is still in need.

Key words: Patriarchal norms, Indian society, feminist movement,

Introduction:

As we all know, feminism is a social movement that advocates for women's rights on the grounds of equality of the genders. There are different opinions and perspective on feminism, which makes it an ideal topic.

The Feminism as a movement, has been gaining momentum all over the world. It is no longer restricted to the western world, but has found its way into other countries as well. Indian literature, which has previously dominated by male authors, has seen a significant shift towards the representation of women's experiences and perspectives. In India, feminism has been gaining ground since the early 20th century, and it has been reflected in the works of Indian writers.

History of Feminism: It is the one which tells us about the feminist movement in India can be traced back to the 19th century when most of the women began to challenge their demand equal right. However, it was not until the early 20th century that feminism gained momentum in India, and this was reflected in literature of India. Indian women started highlighting their sorrows, struggles, aspirations, and desires. All these works were focused on the issues such as discrimination based on gender, violence against women, and the lack of agency that women experienced in society. Generally, right from the old days, India was a male commanded culture. Indian women were secured with some thick, slack layers of bias, show numbness and hesitance in literature just as throughout everyday life. They were lifeless things, who pursued five paces behind their men, they must be delicate, tolerant, benevolent, and for ages together. Bengali women were holed up behind the safeguarded windows of half dim rooms, investing hundreds of years

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in washing garments, massaging batter and mumbling sections from “The Bhagavad Gita and The Ramayana” in the diminish light of dirty lights.’ The Indian lady today is never again a Damayanti, she is a Draupadi or a damius or a Nora or a real to life Joan of Arc or Social reformers of India.

The first Indian feminist Novel: One of the earliest works of Indian literature that reflected the feminist movement was the novel ‘Indulekha’ by O. Chandu Menon. Published in 1889, the novel is considered to be one of the first feminist novels in India. It tells the story of a young woman named Indulekha, who defies her father’s wishes and married the man of her choice. The novel challenged the traditional norms of Indian society, which placed restrictions on women’s choices and mobility.

A feminist novel for India is anything but a novel which a lady composes in light of the fact that she is a lady and realizes how to compose. It is composed by the person who has comprehended a lady both as a lady and as an individual pressurized by a wide range of unmistakable and undetectable, outer and interior powers, by the person who isn’t diverted by feminism. An endeavor will be made to contemplate the different parts of feminism that were taken by Shashi Deshpande in her novels and to perceive how far she has prevailing with regards to verifying for the individuals from her gender, their present accessible status in the family and in the society. Feministic pattern in Indian English Literature bit by bit made a profound effect on other Indian local dialects. Women authors of Kannada unequivocally caused this pattern in their compositions.

Earliest Indian Feminists: One of the earliest feminist writers in India was Sarojini Naidu, who wrote poetry that

highlighted the issues faced by women in society. In her poem “In the Bazaars of Hyderabad,” she portrayed women as active participants in society who were not confined to domestic roles. Another prominent figure in early Indian feminist literature was Kamala Markandeya, who wrote novel that dealt with issues like dowry, marital rape, and domestic violence.

Necessity of Feminism:

Feminism is necessary because it seeks to achieve equality between men and women. For centuries, women have been oppressed and discriminated against in various ways, including denial of basic human rights such as education, voting, and property ownership. Feminism aims to eliminate these inequalities and to empower women to be independent and self-sufficient. It challenges patriarchal systems that limit women's opportunities and marginalize them in society.

Feminism has played a significant role in bringing about positive changes for women, such as legalizing abortion, providing access to education and employment opportunities, and creating laws against gender-based violence.

Impact of Feminism in Society:

In recent years, Indian literature has seen an influx of young writers who are not afraid to take a taboo subjects like female desire, homosexuality, and gender identity. These writers have challenged the heteronormative and patriarchal narrative that has dominated Indian literature for centuries. Some of the most prominent writers in this genre are Arundhati Roy, Kiran Desai, and Anita Desai.

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In 1970s saw the emergence of a new wave of feminist writers in India who were more vocal about their views. Feminist literature in this era dealt with issues like gender inequality, sexuality, and reproductive rights. Some of the most significant works in this genre were “Sultana’s Dream” by Rokeya Sakhawat Hossain and “Lajja” by Taslima Nasreen. Both these works criticized the patriarchal system that oppressed women and advocated for women’s empowerment.

When many people support feminism, there are also those who argue against it. One of the most common criticisms of feminism is that it promotes the idea of women being superior to men. Some people believe that feminism has gone too far and has led to marginalization of men in society. They argue that women already have equal rights, and that further progress can be achieved through cooperation and mutual respect rather than through divisive movements like feminism. Some also believe that feminism is divisive and promotes identity politics, which can lead further discrimination and segregation.

Role of great Feminists: Indian women’s rights mattered to Ambedkar, He wanted women to have greater participation in all walks of life, especially in the political area. The empowerment that, as a legislator under the British regime, he was one of the first people to root for the rights of working women. Ambedkar made a revolutionary change in this matter by insisting that this ‘partial estate’ be converted into ‘absolute estate’, one that a woman could do with as she willed.

Today when women continue to be subjected to sexual abuse, assault, emotional abuse, etc., it becomes even more

important to remember Ambedkar's principles.

In recent years, Indian Literature has seen a significant rise in the number of women writers who are exploring the themes of feminism and gender. One of the most significant contributions of feminist literature in India is that it has given a voice to women who have been oppressed and marginalized. It has allowed women to express their thoughts and feelings and has created a space for women to engage in meaningful discourse about their lives. Feminist literature has also inspired a generation of young women to challenge the status quo and has provided platform for women to speak out against gender-based violence and discrimination.

Some of the notable contemporary writers include Arundhati Roy, Anita Desai, and Jhumpa Lahiri. Arundhati Roy's novel, 'The God of Small Things', explores the themes of gender, class, and caste in Indian society. Anita Desai's novel, 'Clear Light of Day', provides a powerful commentary on the struggles of women in a patriarchal society, and provides a voice to the experiences of women in a globalized world.

Conclusion

In Indian Literature the Emergence of Feminism has a distinctive journey. Indian literature is richer for its feminist works, and it is imperative that we continue to encourage and support women writers who are pushing the boundaries of what is acceptable in our society. Regardless of one's personal opinions & notions it is important to engage in respectful and informed topic of feminism and the other social issues, as this can lead to a better understanding of different aspects and promote positive change in the society. So that we could

see the changes as early as possible in this society in concern to the feminism.

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